Gotham's Fortune Teller

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Gotham's Fortune Teller

by good2evil

Summary

When Robin jumps in front of Batman to protect him from Darkseid's Omega Beam, he expects death, to see the light and then nothing else. What he doesn't expect is to wake up in his ten-year-old self. He especially doesn't expect the power to time travel at will.

Cue shenanigans as he tries to shape the world into his liking, one saved life or relationship at a time. Gotham's never had a more accurate fortune teller. They're lucky Tim chooses not to be a supervillain.

OR

Gotham's fortune teller brings the Batfamily home (and saves many along the way)

Notes

Hi everyone! This is a fun little story about a time traveling Tim Drake as he tries to bring the batfamily home. Each chapter will focus on a member of the batfamily coming or staying home.

This story is a birthday present for my friend, PinkieDev! PinkieDev, I'm so glad that we got to meet and become friends. I love that we were able to bond over fanfiction, and I always enjoy talking with you! Here's to many more birthdays of friendship 💕

I'm going to be posting all the chapters today, so hold tight for the rest of them after I post this first one :)

Also there is one content warning in this first chapter: threat of SA of a minor is alluded to in one sentence, but nothing happens and the minor defends themself. Don't read the last sentence of the paragraph that starts "Crime Alley is just as Tim remembers" if you want to avoid it

I hope you all enjoy this story, because I had a great time writing it!

Curing Empty Nest Syndrome

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Pro-tip: Don't jump in front of suspicious rays, even if you're saving your dad. Heroics is so overrated.

Tim blinks his eyes open, revealing sunlight streaming through a familiar window. A window he hasn't seen in *years.* He shoots up in bed, his childhood bed, to realize that he is in his old bedroom in Drake Manor.

How the hell did I get here? He groans, closing his eyes, trying to remember what happened. The last thing he remembers is fighting Darkseid the Asshole Tyrant, seeing Bruce about to be hit by a laser ray, and-

He sighs, pinching the bridge of his nose. *-jumping in front of him…*

GOD-DAMN IT

Tim did not sign up for whatever the fuck that laser did to him. Knowing that he has to keep a clear head, Tim transitions to Robin mode, carefully investigating where he is.

He gets out of bed only to find that the floor is much closer than what he is used to. Starting to get a sickening feeling of what happened, Tim hurries to the bathroom to look at himself in the mirror.

Confirming the dread building up in his gut, Tim finds that he can barely see his head over the counter. He is at the height before he got his late growth spurt, when most people mistook him for a seven-year-old though he was really ten.

Tim thunks his forehead against the edge of the counter in frustration. He's way too tired to be dealing with this.

Now the question stands, did he go back in time or did he get de-aged?

That question is answered when he hears the loud sound of a motorcycle approaching. Tim sprints to his bedroom window (he *hates* how slow he is now with his short legs) and catches Dick Grayson driving by in a huff.

Now *that* fashion is instantly recognizable. Dick hadn't dressed like that since he had left his Discowing era. Tim shudders to think he'll have to see that monstrosity again. He needs to figure out how to get back before he's subjected to the flashy high collar and cleavage.

The only one with resources and willingness to counteract time travel mishaps lives next door (convenient). Unfortunately, Tim hasn't interacted with him yet outside of galas and late-night patrols (does it count as an interaction if Batman had no idea Tim was there?).

It's okay, Tim. You got this, he hypes himself up, *He adopted you once, and he'll do it again. Just really play up the sad and lonely blue-eyed, black-haired orphan. He's a sucker for them.*

Tim sucks in a breath through his nose when he remembers he's no longer an orphan. For one moment, he's so tempted to try and save everyone's lives. He could see his parents again! Jason may actually like him. Then he snaps himself out of it. No. Time travel protocol postulates that very little can be changed.

He'll get into the Batcave, tell Bruce the code for this situation, and hopefully be home by the end of the day. He hopes the future has dealt with Darkseid already. He really does not want to see that ugly ass face again.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Maybe codes that exist in the future don't exist in the past yet. Just a thought.

Breaking into the Batcave is easy. Apparently the underground caves extend under Drake Manor as well (Tim definitely did not use to play alone in these caves when he was bored. That's depressing. *hides photographic evidence*)

What is not easy is convincing Bruce he comes in peace. In fact, the code he gave meant something entirely different in the past. Why Bruce needed a code for a hallucination trying to gain control of his mind, Tim didn't know (Ok, he did. Bruce was apparently always a paranoid bastard. And to think Tim thought his paranoia was a result of his son's death.).

Needless to say, Tim is currently defending himself against a feral, skeptical Batman while trying to convince him that he's from the future and not a hallucination. His small stature makes it easier to dodge, but jeez Bruce, why is he attacking a small child. Tim is tiny and cute, okay? Tim guesses if he also thought he was being manipulated and is not able to land a hit on a kid that he thinks is a hallucination, he would also act like B. And for that reason alone, Tim will forgive him for the effort he has to make to fight in this child-sized, inconvenient body.

"Tell me something my future son would know that a hallucination wouldn't then," B growls, throwing a punch that Tim quickly ducks away from.

"What's the date?" Tim asks, while trying to trip Batman. B just grunts. Tim's mind races, trying to remember something that will happen soon, but before he can think of something, B kicks him hard into a wall. Tim swears his back realigns after years of being desecrated by bad posture.

Tim lets out a startled cry, and blinks disoriented as he finds himself facing a punch that he had definitely dodged a minute ago.

Confused, Tim hears Batman growl, "Tell me something my future son would know that a hallucination wouldn't then."

What the hell?? This is some serious deja vu.

This time, when Bruce tries to kick Tim, he dodges it, somehow predicting it. *This is creepy,* Tim thinks. But then, he pauses. *Did I just time travel again?* Upon a further check, he realizes his spine is no longer realigned.

This situation is definitely getting more complicated than he originally thought, and clearly Batman is not currently going to be convinced. If he retreats, he knows B will not stop until he tracks him down or knows for sure that he is gone. Given that Tim lives next door, it probably won't take long. Maybe he can make B feel guilty for attacking an actual child? But then, Bruce would want to know how Tim got into the cave and knew a code (that was apparently *wrong*). Tim needs to regroup and come up with a better plan.

That leaves only one option: Tim Travel (*haha get it? Okay I'll stop.*)

He quickly runs through what occurred to make him travel back in time. He purposefully lets B kick him again, feeling his spine realign once more (*ahh, free chiropractor*). Unfortunately, that does not make him go back in time, and his back now aches (*ow.*) He then throws himself at the wall himself, making Batman pause in disbelief, and yells out as he feels a bone in his arm fracture. That was definitely not planned.

Before he can really feel the pain, he finds himself in a cave passage that he had used to sneak into the Batcave. Tim tests his arm and feels no pain. *Yesss!* Tim celebrates that not only was he able to time travel and escape Bruce's wrath, but that the time travel reverts his body to the past as well. No more month-long healing processes!

Now he needs to figure out what exactly caused it, so he can control it. This time, he went further back in time. Maybe it was the injury- *Nope!*

Tim winces as he breaks his finger and nothing happens. Thankfully that is not the reason. Tim would hate to break his bone every time he needed to go back in time.

The only other thing he can think of was that he had cried out both times he time-traveled. It couldn't be that easy…right?

Tim sucks in a huge breath, hoping he won't get attacked by bats, and *screams* .

He lands in his bedroom in Drake Manor, hearing a motorcycle drive past.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 How does Black Canary's throat survive?

Tim has been screaming the Manor down for the past week, figuring out how this new power of his works. It's a good thing Drake Manor is fairly isolated and that no one remembers him screaming, otherwise Tim is sure people would think the Manor was haunted or that Tim needs to go to Arkham.

Tim has noted that the way he screams changes how far back in time he goes. The louder and longer the scream is, the farther back in time he goes. He has already gone through different pitches, volumes, and lengths, writing down how far he went back in time. Maybe he should take vocal lessons. His throat aches almost constantly now. How does Dinah do it?

He also mourns that he'll never be able to fully enjoy a concert again (screaming was always part of the fun), though he *can* watch the concert multiple times. This power is *definitely* worth the perpetual sore throat.

Additionally, Tim has spent time going out and researching the outside world, just to see how he can change outcomes with a little tweak.

For example, he broke into Wayne Manor and stole Bruce's coffee before he could drink it, screaming before anyone could stop him. He ended up back in his room, holding the coffee pot in his hands. Turns out, he can bring stuff back in time with him. He hasn't tried it with a human yet, just in case it hurts them. Plus he doesn't want to expose himself to anyone just yet.

He's since realized that he shouldn't go to Bruce yet, even if he could prove the time travel, because if Tim is a meta that time travels, then it will be basically impossible to send him back to his older body in the future. It is himself that is time-traveling, not any device that is the cause. Whatever Darkseid used could probably not be counteracted if it affected his genetic makeup, and it would take too long to try and find him. The closest solution would be for the Flash to bring him back to the future, but Tim would still be ten, and there is *no way* he wants to be younger than Damian.

Tim has also realized that he can cause as much chaos as he wants because he can always go back in time if something goes horribly wrong. So fuck it. This is an opportunity to get it right this time! No dead Robin, no grieving Batman, no homicidal little brother, and no strained familial relationships. Tim is going to fix the Wayne family himself or die trying (hopefully he can avoid that though). He doesn't want Bruce interfering with his plans to wreak havoc and change everything.

Tim has already had some fun. After stealing Bruce's coffee pot, he tried watching the aftermath with his camera zoom. He snapped a few great pictures of Bruce's despair as he rummaged through the entire kitchen looking for it. Not even Alfred's disapproval stopped him from throwing open each cabinet and slumping every time he couldn't find the coffee. Tim cackled while watching, sipping said coffee directly from the pot. Serves him right for trying to beat Tim up.

Tim's first goal in changing the timeline is to fix B and Dick's relationship. When Bruce took Jason in, he and Dick were still fighting and it made the tension even worse. Bruce was suffering from empty nest syndrome, missing Dick and hoping he would come home. Tim thinks a part of why Bruce took Jason in was because he was lonely and wanted another child to dote on as Dick wasn't speaking to him (the other part is obviously that Jason needed the help and that Bruce connected with him). Dick, on the other hand, felt replaced by a newer model (Tim guesses it's a thing when someone gets a little sibling, and he hadn't understood until Damian came along).

Bruce adopting Jason, but not Dick, was the final straw, and Dick's resentment of Jason not only ruined the brotherly relationship they could have had, but also contributed to Dick's guilt surrounding Jason's death. All in all, Tim has determined that B and Dick *suck* at communicating. They both love each other, but their idea of their relationship is clashing. Dick wants to be adopted and thinks Bruce doesn't want to, so he's angry at Bruce for trying to parent him. He's also an adult and needs his independence, but he still wants his family to support him without trying to control his life. Bruce thinks Dick doesn't want to be adopted, but still wants to parent and protect him because he thinks of Dick as his son.

It's a mess that could all be solved by a discussion of boundaries and their true feelings. Getting them to talk to one another is the difficulty in reaching this goal. Dick is currently ignoring Bruce's calls, while Bruce sulks all day and night. Tim is sure he can figure it all out though.

He wakes up a week after discovering his meta-abilities (which is really the next day because of his time traveling), smirking and ready to start step one of his plan.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Is it really kidnapping if you're a kid as well?

Crime Alley is just as Tim remembers. He's already had to use his power three times in the 15 minutes he's been there to avoid getting killed or mugged. He's lucky his reflexes made him unconsciously scream just before some thug pulled the trigger of a gun. He *cannot* die before he even starts. Tim is stubborn and determined enough to continue on despite everything that is thrown at his poor ten-year-old self. He even had to castrate some creep that tried to make moves on him.

No matter what, Tim needs to find what he is looking for. Wracking his brain, he tries to remember where Jason said he used to sleep when on the streets. Jason never really talked about this time unless he wanted to make a scathing remark about Tim's rich upbringing.

Regardless of Jason's hatred of Tim, Tim is not going to let his Robin stay on the streets when he has a whole manor to himself. Maybe a little part of him is hoping that Jason, his idol, will like him this time without death, resentment, and the Pit interfering.

Tim has a backup plan of waiting by cars in the general area with the hopes of catching Jason trying to jack tires.

Eventually, Tim climbs up to the rooftops to avoid altercations and has a bird's eye view of the area. His experience stalking Batman really comes in handy as he is able to stick to the shadows and avoid detection. He also remembers good hiding spots in the area.

When Tim is hiding on a rafter overlooking a gang fight, he notices a figure crouched in the corner right underneath him, trying to go unnoticed. The scrawny, child-like body is holding a tire jack and wrench. Bingo. The sleeveless jean jacket is a dead (or should he say undead) giveaway.

Looks like Jason accidentally got caught in a gang fight. Never fear, a Tim Traveler is here! Tim gives a small cry and finds himself transported around half an hour back in time. He sprints on the rooftops to the area he had seen Jason in and gets there just in time to see Jason in the middle of jacking a Tesla (Doing everyone a public service. He's a hero like Robin already!).

Before the gang fight can start, Tim sneaks into the driver's side of the car (Tim's Bat training makes it easy to hack), and drops his backpack in the back. He enables child lock before sneaking around to the passenger side and opening the door. Jason is too focused on the tire jacking of the back passenger side tire that he doesn't notice Tim sneaking up behind him. No matter how jumpy and alert he is as a street kid, Jason is no match for a trained bat that has spent his whole life trying to be unobtrusive and unnoticeable.

Sorry Jason..but this is for the best.

Tim grabs the twelve-year-old. He's scarily light enough that Tim, who is way smaller and younger, is able to manhandle him into the passenger seat and close the door. Jason bangs on the door, cursing up a storm, as he tries to open it. Tim quickly removes the tire jack and tightens the tire screws as much as he can before running to get into the drivers seat.

He anticipates the punch so he's able to block it. He regrets not pushing Jason into the backseat. As he's trying to stop Jason from fighting him, the gunfight starts up, startling Jason enough to jerk back.

Tim uses the opportunity to put the car into drive and step on the gas. Jason yells out, "What the fuck are you doing?? You're too fucking young to drive. How are you even reaching the pedals??"

He hurriedly plugs in his seatbelt, holding tightly to the overhead hand hold when he notices that Tim has to slide to the very end of the seat to reach the gas pedal. "Who the hell are you?

What do you want with me?" Jason continues panicking. He tries kicking Tim, but that makes the car swerve and Jason quickly gives up on fighting the driver.

This is admittedly not what Tim had initially planned. He thought he would talk to Jason and convince him to come with Tim before taking him to Drake Manor in a cab. However, the gang fight gave Tim a time crunch, and it's much easier to have Jason listen if he can't run away.

"I'm your younger brother from the future," Tim says monotonously, probably adding to Jason's hysteria.

"Oh my god, I'm gonna die," Jason moans, "I'm stuck in a car with a crazy kid."

"Don't worry, Jason, I'm going to explain everything when we get to my house," Tim reassures him.

"How the fuck do you know my name?!" Jason exclaims, getting even more panicked, which is the opposite of what Tim intended.

Tim can see how it would be creepy for a stranger to know your name and kidnap you, but Tim's small and innocent-looking! Most people aren't scared of him.

"Like I said. I know you in the future, and I'll explain everything when we get back to my place. I promise I won't hurt you. I'll even let you hold a knife if it makes you feel better. It's in my backpack along with some snacks you can eat," Tim says, tilting his head towards the back.

Jason rummages through the bag cautiously, when he finds the knife and some packaged snacks, he grips the knife tightly in one hand while hoovering down the food. "Don't think you can win me over with food," he grumbles, "that's exactly what creepy kidnappers do."

Tim shrugs. He knows that he is very suspicious at the moment, but he hopes Jason believes him when he explains. He's already set up a bedroom for him, with some of the books he knows Jason likes. Maybe Jason will be more willing to stay if he sees the library.

The rest of the drive to Drake Manor is filled with silence except for the rustling of snack packages. Jason is leaned as far away from Tim as possible, eyeing him warily.

When they finally pull into the barely used driveway, Jason's eyes widen. "Damn, no wonder you're weird. You're a rich asshole," he blurts out.

"My parents are, not me," Tim defends, "Anyway, I'm here alone, so you don't have to worry about running into anyone else."

"What? You're like five. You shouldn't be living alone!" Jason exclaims incredulously.

"I'm not five! I'm ten for your information. Plus I'm technically older than you cuz I'm a time traveler. I'm mentally 17. Also I'm not living alone anymore, I have you!" Tim counters.

"Whoa, whoa, whoa! There's so much to unpack here. First of all, how am I supposed to believe that you're somehow a 17-year-old time traveler? Second of all, who says I'm going to be living with you? You could be a serial killer, or work for a human trafficking ring!" Jason replies.

"Ugh I'll give you proof when we go inside, but first if I tell you a secret, will you trust me?" Tim asks.

"Depends on what the secret is.." Jason says skeptically.

"You'll figure it out in the future anyway, and I'll just time travel if you try to tell anyone, so don't even try it," Tim warns.

“I’m not a snitch!” Jason scowls.

“Ok!” Tim leans in to whisper, “Bruce Wayne is Batman…”

Jason bursts out laughing. “Ok, I knew you were kooky but this is on a whole ‘nother level of conspiracy,” he cackles.

Tim glares at him. “That’s it! If you're refusing to believe me then come inside and I’ll show you evidence. He gets out of the car and stomps to the passenger side, pulling a still cackling Jason out of the car. He drags his stupid older brother up the steps and into the large manor.

Jason shuts up when they’re inside, staring wide-eyed at the ornate entrance room.

“Steal whatever you want,” Tim tells him flippantly. Most of the artifacts are stolen by his parents anyway.

He leads Jason to the bedroom he set up for him, showing him the library on the way. Jason is stunned into silence the whole way. When Tim shows him the books he had collected for him, Jason’s silence breaks. “Why are you doing all this for me? I know you think I’m your brother or whatever, but why are you helping someone who doesn’t know you so much?”

Tim turns to give Jason a soft smile, explaining, “Because…you’re my Robin. You inspired me to do good and be a hero myself! Even if you weren’t my brother, I would have still helped you because that’s what you taught me.”

Jason’s mouth drops open, and then he snaps it shut, clearing his throat thickly. “I’m..I’m not Robin…I wish I was though…”

“You’re not Robin *yet* . In the future Batman, Bruce Wayne, adopts you and you become Robin after the current Robin becomes Nightwing,” Tim informs him.

“Oh..”

There's a brief pause before Jason shakes himself out of his thoughts. “What the hell! Why not? If you’re gonna give me food and let me live here with that library, then I’ll believe whatever you tell me. I still think you’re nutty, but it’s way better living here than where I was before,” he decides.

“Great!” Tim says, “I need your help with a plan I’ve got.”

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 @life_is_a_soup_and_im_a_fork Phase 2 initiated.

After getting Jason settled into the manor, Tim tells him about his plan to get Bruce and Dick to make up.

Throughout the past few days, Tim has been slowly proving to Jason that he actually has time travel powers.

He went back in time to hand Jason the food he was craving before he could ask for it, he asked about Pride and Prejudice before Jason even tells him he’s started reading the book, and he brought him the phone charger he had misplaced before Jason could ask if he had seen it.

All of these small things culminate in Jason cornering Tim and interrogating him about what is going on. This leads to Tim giving him the run down of Bruce and Dick’s relationship, and how he wants to get them to talk to each other and communicate.

“Why is this so important to you? Besides the fact that you think they’re Batman and Robin,” Jason questions, rolling his eyes.

“Because they’re your future family, Jason! They need to be in a good place, so it’s better for you when Bruce adopts you. Dick will be a great big brother to you if he doesn’t resent you, and Bruce will be in a better mood. Living in Wayne Manor will be way nicer if there’s no tension in the family,” Tim explains.

“Who said anything about Bruce adopting me?? I don’t need no adult in my life to control me. I’m perfectly fine living with you!” Jason says angrily.

“But he needs to adopt you for you to be Robin! Plus, you’ll love him. You need more than just a brother Jason. I’ll be here for you too, but you also need time to just be a kid. Let the adults handle taking care of you. Bruce is a good dad once you get used to his emotional incompetence. He will care for you and love you a lot, I know it,” Tim wheedles.

Jason sighs and seems resigned. “I don’t fully believe you, but your plan sounds like fun, so I’ll go along with it. I’d love to mess with a billionaire. Plus, *someone* needs to keep you from going completely insane,” he admits.

Tim cheers. *Finally!!* After days of planning and execution, Tim can finally work with Jason to bring the Wayne family back together.

After a day of brainstorming, Jason agrees with Tim that the best way to subtly engineer a reconciliation from afar is to use social media. Because Bruce is such a public figure, it won’t take long to get his attention. Tim will use his power *responsibly* by stalking both Dick and B (never Alfred. Tim respects him enough not to stalk him), going back in time, and posting specific predictions that come true to gain their attention. Working together to figure out who is behind the predictions and how they are doing it will be a great bonding experience. He’s also not above exposing their true feelings if they’re being especially stubborn.

At long last, Jason believes Tim about Batman’s identity when Tim sneaks them into the Batcave with the intention of planting cameras and bugs.

“How are we going to stalk Batman??”

“Don’t worry! I did it for years and he never caught me.”

“ *WHAT THE FUCK?!* ”

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 The Penguin’s going to try and escape a fight with Batman by floating away on his umbrella, but his pants are going to get stuck on the top of a tall gate and cause him to fall to the ground in his underwear lmao. #penguinwearstightywhities

@random_gothamite hilarious ahahaha. They’re selling posters of the picture.

@smartest_goon uh...guys, this was posted before it happened. Did OP manifest it?

@blonde_conspiracy_theorist Can you see the future? Do you work as a fortune teller? My last one got arrested for fraud, so I’m looking for a new one.

Tim starts out posting innocuous things about general public events he sees on the news to start building a following and establish a name for his account as a fortune telling one. This will make his posts more credible, so they’re not immediately dismissed. He even predicts his account being on the news, channel and time included. As attention on his account increases, he starts focusing more on public news about Bruce Wayne and Dick Grayson.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Watch out @the_real_Bruce_Wayne. Vicki Vale is going to “accidentally” walk into your bedroom at your next gala. Better keep it barricaded.

@life_is_a_soup_and_im_a_fork creepy bitch 🤮

@gala_enthusiast yo that was wild! wayne's butler literally gave her the walk of shame out of the manor.

@eat_the_rich dude should have barricaded his door like you told him to

This one was slightly less fun. Tim and Jason couldn't really bug a lot of the manor because Alfred would for sure find them, so they stuck to mostly only bugging the Batcave. This means they have to take more difficult measures to figure out what goes on in the manor. They have binoculars and camera zoom to see what is happening, but they have to rely on only a few bugs to hear conversations.

Tim sneaks into the gala under the excuse of filling in for his parents, but can't really see anything interesting until he is sneaking past Bruce's bedroom and hears rustling inside it. Now Tim knows for sure that Bruce and Alfred are downstairs because he had used that opportunity to sneak out. Opening the door, Tim gasps as he discovers Vicki Vale looking through Bruce's bedroom, probably looking for a scoop. Quickly, Tim screams to be sent back in the past. After he explains what happened to Jason, who has to angrily punch a pillow in disgust about the invasion of privacy, Tim goes back to the gala and notifies Alfred about a noise he heard when coming back from using the restroom.

Seeing Vicki Vale being marched out of the manor is very satisfying, but a protective instinct in Tim is still horrified at her violating his (future) dad's privacy.

…

@tim_is_money C8H10N4O2

Maybe the police force isn't the right fit for a born acrobat. @dick_the_flying_grayson will vault over a cabbage cart, causing the vendor to yell out, "My cabbages!", while trying to chase a suspect and will jump a little too high, whacking his head on an overhead sign. He ends up having to pay for all the cabbages because he gets blood all over them from his bruised nose and the suspect gets away (they are later arrested by new vigilante Nightwing).

@life_is_a_soup_and_im_a_fork 😂😂💀

@blonde_conspiracy_theorist guys I think Dick Grayson is Nightwing. Bro probably caught the suspect as revenge. I think Nightwing's nose looked a little pink…

@eat_the_rich yeah no way Bruce Wayne's ward has the morality to uphold social justice. He's rich *and* a cop.

@electric_bluebird um… who's dick grayson?

@dick_the_flying_grayson How the heck did you know this was going to happen?? It's so specific. Now I need to check your page before going on shift smh 😭 I have enough cabbages to feed the local shelter for a week 🥬

Tim's oldest brother is sooo stupid. Tim loves him so much.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Batman will face a terrible foe tonight when Condiment King takes to the streets, relishing in condiment chaos. Condiment King will be defeated tonight, but not without landing a few delicious hits to the Dark Knight. Hope he brings some towels or the Batmobile is going to be covered in sauce for the foreseeable future.

@Not_Batman Thank you for the towel suggestion.

@random_gothamite THANK YOU SO MUCH! I swear I'm so glad I decided to stay home after seeing your post. My husband went to work and I had to spray him down outside before he got ketchup stains on our cream carpet.

@batman_pics Getting some closeups of Batman trying to waddle to his car while covered in various condiments was so worth getting blasted by some mustard. *image attached*

@Not_Batman How do you dislike a post twice?

Tim and Jason giggle as they look through the many pictures the two had gotten of the fight. Tim had found the best hiding spot for them to get a great view without being sprayed by mayonnaise.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Nightwing will be in Gotham tonight to track down a suspect in one of his cases! Do you think he and Batman will get along? (Spoiler alert: they end up in a screaming match outside a Batburger)

@blonde_conspiracy_theorist WHICH BATBURGER?????

@purple_waffles I love spoilers! Now I have entertainment to go along with my dinner.

@electric_bluebird Never solving a case in Gotham again! If a suspect reaches Gotham it's Mr. I Am The Night's problem.

Tim sighs. It's going to be so hard to have them work it out if they can't even keep the fighting out of their vigilante identities. It's time to up the ante.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Bruce Wayne will find the tires of his favorite car missing. After spilling his coffee on the way to work, having a business meeting with Lex Luthor, and getting bird poop on his suit, this seems to be the breaking point for his bad day. How the tires ended up in his basement, I have no idea.

@the_real_Bruce_Wayne How could you possibly have known that was going to happen?

@purple_waffles Omg it actually happened?? I would so pay to watch your reaction lmao.

@eat_the_rich Sounds like a typical Brucie Wayne day

@Not_Batman Answer your direct messages.

@random_gothamite Wow! Our fortune teller must really know a LOT about Bruce Wayne.

@blonde_conspiracy_theorist Oooo maybe the fortune teller knows Bruce Wayne personally

@eat_the_rich It would so make sense if this was a PR stunt

@blonde_conspiracy_theorist But that doesn't explain how they were able to predict the public events like Penguin's mishap. Unless Penguin paid them as well, though it doesn't look like he enjoyed the humiliation.

@life_is_a_soup_and_i'm_a_fork No fucking way Bruce Wayne intentionally puts himself through that. He may be an airhead, but even *he* wouldn't think of that as a PR stunt. Especially because it wasn't even on the news. The only reason we know this is cuz of this account.

@eat_the_rich True

Tim has started to post more specific and private things about people's lives. His main focus is on Bruce and Dick, but to not raise suspicion he also posted about other public figures' private lives. Apparently, Gotham's Mayor has been having affairs, and the only reason his wife found out was because Tim predicted that he was going to rent a hotel room with one of his sugar babies the following night. The fallout was impeccable. Tim hopes his wife runs as mayor next.

After Tim told Jason about how he got adopted the first time around, Jason has been itching to steal the Batmobile tires for fun. They stole the tires when Batman was on patrol and snuck them into the Batcave. Tim's post about this event was especially important because it reveals that he knows Batman's secret identity. He mentions Bruce Wayne's tires even though it was actually Batman's, and he found them in the Batcave, not basement.

This has seemed to freak Bruce out, and light a fire under him to find out who is behind the account, judging by the shit-ton of DMs he sent the account. Tim is ignoring it, and Bruce's increasing panic is edging him closer to reaching out to Dick for help. Tim is slightly worried about him contacting Babs, but at this point she isn't as tech-savvy as Tim. All Tim needs is one more push for Batman and Nightwing to start working together, he just knows it.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Dick Grayson is about to run out of cereal at exactly 10:08 am, and his pantry will officially be empty. Maybe he should head over to Wayne Manor for some real food..I heard the butler makes a delicious reuben with extra sauerkraut.

@dick_the_flying_grayson Um…how do you know that?? My pantry is my business??? Also how did you know my favorite sandwich? This started out funny, but now it's creepy.

@penny1 Master Dick. Please refrain from worrying me about your eating habits. I expect you at six sharp for dinner.

@dick_the_flying_grayson ALFRED????? Since when do you have twitter??

@penny1 Since I need to know how you are doing, and I only hear news from this account. Thank heavens they informed me of the state of your pantry.

@dick_the_flying_grayson Sorry, Alfie :(I'll call more often.

@penny1 As is expected. Make it up to me by attending dinner.

@dick_the_flying_grayson ok :(

@life_is_a_soup_and_i'm_a_fork It's creepier to only have cereal in your pantry.

Tim is drooling just imagining Alfred's cooking, but quickly shakes himself out of it. He and Jason will hopefully be able to have it soon if the plan continues going smoothly. Tim and Jason celebrated Alfred forcing Dick over for dinner by buying giant sundaes and cake from Gotham's best diner and riding out the food coma in Drake Manor's cinema room.

They then prepare to observe how the dinner goes through an incredibly intricate surveillance setup.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Bruce Wayne has had adoption papers in his desk for Dick Grayson since the moment he became his ward, but doesn't think Dick wants to be adopted (he hasn't even asked lol). One comment from a grieving child about him never replacing his parents and he doesn't think he can be an additional one?

@dick_the_flying_grayson …really?

@purple_waffles Omg he's so emotionally stunted lmaooo

@random_gothamite Does Dick want to be adopted?

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Yup ;)

@the_real_Bruce_Wayne Please refrain from talking about private matters on the internet or you'll be hearing from my lawyer.

@life_is_a_soup_and_im_a_fork Yeah right. Do you even know who this is? They'll probs see it coming a mile away.

After a week of Dick and Bruce working together to find Tim, they still haven't talked about anything personal. If Tim hears about how bad the weather is *one more time* , he is going to scream (which is not conducive to him avoiding the statement again). They haven't talked about anything other than work or mundane things, which is working wonders on them not fighting, but they haven't worked *anything* out. They've just put their problems on hold.

Tim has decided that he needs to move to the second stage of posts where he bluntly exposes things that the two of them refuse to bring up on their own. Hopefully this will prompt them to *finally* talk about it.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 @the_real_Bruce_Wayne Empty nesters try to keep their kids close because they miss them, but their children need their independence. The best way to have the kids want to visit is by letting them come to you when they want and keeping communication lines open without being overbearing…

@the_real_Bruce_Wayne Who are you to tell me how to parent?

@life_is_a_soup_and_im_a_fork Doesn't look like you and your kid are getting along rn. Maybe you do need the parenting advice.

@dick_the_flying_grayson This would actually work, B. I'm an adult and I hate when you try to control my life. Just support what I decide to do, and I'll talk to you more often. I miss you too (when you're not judging my life).

@the_real_Bruce_Wayne Okay, chum. I'll try.

@eat_the_rich as heartwarming as this is, do you really need to have heart to hearts on the internet? Talk to each other in person guys, or at the very least call.

…

@tim_is_money C8H10N4O2

@the_real_Bruce_Wayne @dick_the_flying_grayson Sometimes it's best to actually *say* "I love you" instead of assuming they know through your actions.

@random_gothamite Um.. this is getting kinda weird. They seem a little too invested in Bruce Wayne's relationship with his son…

@gala_enthusiast shhh I love the drama going down sm

@life_is_a_soup_and_im_a_fork I feel like there's a reason behind this

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 There is! I predict a fraught and complicated relationship between them for the rest of their lives if it isn't resolved soon.

@blonde_conspiracy_theorist awww that's very nice of you to help with their relationship 😊

If it wasn't the undenied explanation of each side of the story, it was the thought of never having a good relationship again that nudged Bruce and Dick to sit down and have a serious discussion about their boundaries and feelings. Soon after Tim's latest post, Dick started going over to Wayne Manor for weekly dinners. Tim and Jason hear his motorcycle drive by on Saturday nights, hurriedly going up to the roof where they have the best view of Wayne Manor's dining room.

It looks like they are slowly repairing their familial bond, getting to know how each of them have grown and changed. As the weekly dinners progress, there seems to be less tension and arguments have turned more playful and lighthearted. Of course, it wasn't linear progress and there were times when Tim wanted to go over there and smack them both upside the head, but they slowly got into the rhythm of a father-son relationship that worked for both of them.

Tim debated introducing Jason to them soon, but there was still one more thing he was holding out for them to talk about. It was a muggy summer night when it finally happened. Dinner had ended and the two of them had gone down to the Batcave to work on a case together. Finding Tim had been lowered in priority because Tim had stopped posting anything incriminating about them once they got their shit together.

Right now, there is a smuggling operation going down between a gang in Gotham and a gang in Bludhaven. Tim has already found a way to take it down, but in the effort of making them spend more time together, he encrypted the answers in a code that doesn't exist yet (Tim's still being petty about his first meeting with Bruce) and sent it to them anonymously.

Listening through the bugs they planted, Tim hears Bruce ask Dick, "Can you please bring a flash drive I have in my study? I asked Lucius to compile the decryptions for most codes. It should be able to bypass whatever this is."

"Sure, B!" Dick chirps, hurrying to Bruce's study. Tim and Jason watch as he rummages through Bruce's desk. Tim knows it's actually in Bruce's briefcase, but it's not like he can do anything from here. Dick pulls out a file, but when he goes to put it on the desk to keep searching, a paper falls from it onto the floor. He freezes once he's picked it up and seen what it says.

No way. Tim can't be that lucky can he?

Dick puts it back in the folder, and seemingly forgetting what he needs to do, he walks back to the cave with a tense expression on his face.

Bruce's back is to him as he works on the Batcomputer, but he turns quickly when Dick speaks up, "That fortune telling account wasn't lying, was it?"

Dick is holding up the folder that Tim knows is adoption papers, dating all the way back to when Dick first went to stay with him. Bruce's eyes widen, and he can't seem to say anything except, "Y-Yes."

There's a silence between them as they both try to figure out what to say. *Come on, Bruce,* Tim thinks.

Bruce visibly steels himself, which speaks a lot to how flustered he is because he usually has full control over his facial expressions. "Chum.." he starts out stiltedly, "I.. have always thought of you as a son.. even though you were insistent on us being partners. I just wanted to be whatever you'll let me be for you, but I see now that I've hurt you by not being up front."

Dick looks to be holding his breath, expression hopeful. Bruce continues, "I never want to replace your parents, but I'd like it if I could be another father for you. When my parents died, Alfred became like a father to me, and I'm sorry I couldn't see that you would want it to be like that for us as well. You are my light, and I could never be happy without you in my life."

Both of them have started tearing up at this point, and Tim and Jason don't admit that they're tearing up as well. "You are my son no matter what, but will you do me the honor of allowing me to officially adopt you?" Bruce asks tightly, a touch fearful.

This is the most emotionally eloquent Tim has ever heard Bruce be, and he can't stop from feeling proud of his dad for becoming vulnerable for Dick, to show how much he trusts and loves him.

Dick drops the file, papers flying everywhere, but everyone's attention is on him as he jumps into B's arms sobbing. "Yes, B! I love you. You've done so much for me, and I'm so glad I have you as a dad."

Bruce rubs his back, humming. "I love you too," he whispers, barely audible, for Dick's ears only.

Tim and Jason cheer while stuffing their faces with popcorn. They had planned to watch a movie, but this was much better entertainment. Soon, they walk back into the house to give Dick and Bruce their privacy back, and Tim decides it’s time to introduce them to Jason.

Chapter End Notes

This chapter mainly focused on repairing Dick and Bruce's relationship, and the next one will focus on another Bat.

There was a lot that happened in this chapter. For example: the kidnapping. I feel like Tim could so be an amazing supervillain if he was a bad person. His morals and kindness are the only things keeping him from world domination, so I wanted to show this potential haha. I also think Tim wouldn't want to leave Jason to the streets if he knew he was there, but didn't want to deal with slowly earning his trust, so voila, he just forced Jason to listen to him lol.

I also hope the formatting isn't too hard to follow. It was a little hard to figure out how to do the posts because I couldn't use tab like I did in my document.

Hope you enjoyed this first chapter! Stay tuned for the next one 😊

Freeing a Bat from his Cage

Chapter Summary

Tim and Jason infiltrate Wayne Manor and plot how to break into the League of Assassins.

Chapter Notes

Hey guys! Here's chapter 2! I personally think this is one of my favorite chapters, so I hope you like it too!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Family reunions: you either hate ‘em or love ‘em.

Tim rings the buzzer at Wayne Manor’s gate nervously. The last time he was here was for the gala, but it’s been a while since he was at the manor as a part of the family. He misses being able to just drive in, the gates welcoming him automatically.

Jason is fidgeting beside him, probably a lot more nervous than him. Unlike Tim, Jason hasn’t actually met anyone at Wayne Manor. No matter how many times Tim reassures him about how they’re going to love him, Jason won’t completely believe it until Tim is proven right.

They had chosen to visit during Saturday dinner so Dick would be there too. It takes a moment to get a response as Alfred is probably busy cleaning up the table. When they do get a response, it’s in the form of a polite, curious greeting. “Hello?”

“Hello Mr. Pennyworth,” Tim greets calmly despite his nerves, “I’m Tim Drake, your neighbor, and I am wondering if my friend and I can talk to Mr. Wayne about something. It’s urgent!”

There's a pause as Alfred deliberates over Tim's request, but eventually there's a buzz and click as the gates swing open. Tim and Jason glance at each other wide-eyed for a second before making their way to the front door. As they make their way up the porch steps, the large double doors of Wayne Manor creak open to reveal Alfred Pennyworth in all his glory.

“Mr. Drake,” Alfred addresses him, and then turns to Jason in a silent inquiry about his name. Jason looks at him confusedly, not understanding what to do, so Tim speaks up for him. “This is Jason Todd,” Tim introduces, “he’s my new adopted brother.”

Alfred raises a skeptical eyebrow. “I did not know that the Drakes adopted a boy,” he replies, a question in his tone.

“They didn’t,” Tim explains, “I did.”

Jason snorts in amusement, seemingly relaxed now that Tim has taken the lead. He is content at the moment to hang back and see how Tim’s plan plays out. There’s not *too* much risk, they both know. Tim can always go back in time until the interaction goes well. Tim only hopes that Jason keeps his attitude on the down-low until Bruce agrees to take him in, but then again..that may have been why Bruce liked Jason so much.

“Ah..” Alfred says dryly, his impeccable composure allowing him to breeze past that statement politely. “Please, do come in,” he invites, stepping back to allow their entry.

He then guides the two boys up the grand staircase and towards a sitting room that Tim recognizes as one where Bruce receives guests. Tim and Jason sit on a fancy futon as Alfred goes to collect Bruce. In the meantime, Tim pulls out his laptop from his backpack.

When Bruce enters the room, he looks upon them curiously. He sits on an armchair that faces the futon and leans forward, intently looking at their faces.

“How can I help you boys?” he asks gently.

Tim opens up his laptop, and loads up his presentation. “Mr. Wayne,” he starts, “I believe that I have found a perfect adopted son for you, and here are the reasons why.”

Bruce's mouth drops open in shock as Jason dissolves into cackles. Jason hadn't yet seen Tim's presentation so everything he is showing is completely new to everyone but himself.

1. *Jason is an amazing little brother that Dick would love.*
2. *You like to take in good-hearted, black-haired, blue-eyed orphans and he fits this description.*
3. *He has a tragic backstory, and you have a bleeding heart. He needs your help* 🥺
4. *I know you miss parenting, so you have another opportunity since Dick is moved out*
5. *He's the one who stole your tires, which means he's clever and brave.*
6. *We know about your night job and if you won't listen to reason, I'm afraid we'll have to blackmail you instead. *tons of pictures they took including the condiment one**

Throughout this entire presentation, Jason and Bruce have contrasting reactions. Jason seems to find this entertaining while Bruce looks horrified.

“I..do not know what you mean by night job,” Bruce tries to deny, but the two boys roll their eyes.

Jason scoffs, finally speaking, “Yeah right, old man. It’s pretty obvious when we live next to you. Plus this squirt,” he ruffles Tim’s hair, who scowls, pushing his hand away, “is fucking smart, and figured it out a while ago. Better tell Dickhead not to show off.”

“Language,” Bruce responds unconsciously, seemingly lost in his head. Jason scowls.

After Tim explains to Bruce how he figured out their identities and Jason makes fun of him about the tires, Bruce calls to Dick who had been watching a movie in their cinema room.

“Master Bruce, please refrain from yelling across the manor,” Alfred scolds sternly, as he makes his way into the room with a tea set. Both his eyebrows raise when he notices Tim’s presentation.

“Well,” he muses, “I believe it will be best for me to stay here as well.”

He stands behind Bruce’s armchair as the group waits for Dick to join them. Their future adopted brother pounds down the hallway and jogs into the sitting room.

“What’s up?” he chirps. He freezes when he looks around and spots the presentation as well. “Um…” he mumbles, speechless (the first time Tim has ever witnessed this).

“This is your new little brother,” Tim gestures to Jason, “say ‘hi’!”

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Brothers suck 😑

Now, Tim knows that he can always go back in time if things go wrong. However, he doesn’t know if he can prevent this. Chronos, he hates when things don’t go to plan. He thought he was past this when he got his power.

“You should adopt Tim too,” Jason says, voice cutting through the room. They had all finished discussing Jason’s backstory and why he was living with Tim. Tim made sure to really play it up, while Jason made snarky quips about his horrible childhood to really showcase his desensitization. They admired Tim’s photos, but told him not to follow them around anymore because it was dangerous (like he’d ever stop cuz of that 🙄).

Tim thinks he really did accomplish his goal. The residents of Wayne Manor have fallen in love with Jason. Dick has already started calling him Little Wing (Tim’s heart aches every time he calls Tim ‘baby bird’). Bruce has already gone on the phone to talk to a social

worker, and Alfred has inquired about Jason's favorite foods (never mind that he also asked Tim).

"What?" Tim blurts out, "But I'm not an orphan.."

Jason scoffs angrily, "Yeah, but your parents might as well be dead. In the weeks I've been there, I haven't seen them or any other adult except your housekeeper occasionally."

Tim pouts, feeling betrayed. He's mentally an adult thank you very much, and Jason knows that.

"What?!" Dick exclaims, "You don't have an adult in the house taking care of you?" Alfred looks serious, and Bruce, who seems to overhear, starts talking to the social worker more urgently. Tim hears his name mentioned, and his stomach drops.

He's come a long way from the boy who thought he was a burden and that his parents still loved him even though they were never there unless it was a gala. He knows that he was neglected, and he learned what a real family was like with the Waynes, though Jason's Pit Rage and the addition of an assassin child shook that up. However, he still thinks he can prevent Jason's death without living in Wayne Manor. It may be even easier to rescue Damian because he won't be constantly monitored and treated like an actual child. It'll be so annoying trying to lose the bats if he has a curfew.

"It's okay guys, I can take care of myself," Tim tries to say, but the traitor shakes his head, protesting, "I'll miss hanging out with you! Who am I going to stalk people with? Plus we'll have endless sleepovers like in Drake Manor. Isn't that what brothers do? They live together as kids."

Tim fumes, but Dick is nodding in agreement sagely. "Don't worry about it, Timmy! You don't need to take care of yourself. You have a family now!" Ugh. Guess he can use his power to avoid them if he needs to sneak out.

Tim doesn't admit it, but he feels a warmth at being accepted back into Wayne Manor with open arms.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Robin resurrection??

Tim miscalculated. In all his dread about having to act like an actual kid and dodge parental supervision, he completely forgot something else kids have to do. He has to go back to school. He. is. horrified.

Tim had tried getting out of it by sneaking off and marking himself automatically present in class, but Jason had ruined yet another plan. He kept an eye out for Tim, and threatened to tell Bruce, to tell *Alfred* , about Tim skipping. Jason has taken his big brother role very seriously.

Jason has been thriving in school, his love of learning encouraging his academic achievements. He joined the theatre and literature clubs, and threw himself into studying, the nerd.

Tim on the other hand is *so. bored.* He's learnt all of this already, and he literally could be doing so much more productive things. He didn't need to graduate high school to be a good CEO before.

The only thing that makes Gotham Academy bearable is that he has Jason with him. Tim was able to skip two grades, so they're in the same class. Tim never had friends in school before, but having Jason there as a friend and brother makes his time there so much better. He's even been able to get along with a few of his classmates this time around (though who knows if they're just sucking up to him as Bruce Wayne's foster kid).

Bruce's permanent custody went through pretty quickly when no one could reach Tim's parents to attend court. Tim doesn't know if his parents even know that he's no longer in their custody. They haven't kicked up a fuss yet, and they aren't in a country where they can be extradited to the US for arrest. Tim hopes they don't know because if they do and aren't even trying to fight for him, it hurts like pressing on a bruise. No matter how much Tim feels indifferent about his parents now, there is still a deep down part of him that is still a child wanting his parents' love.

Tim is interrupted from his grumbling over his homework (😡) when Dick texts him, requesting his presence in the Batcave.

Tim hasn't been allowed down there too often (that they know of lol) except for training (he's probably on par with Dick in skill, but his body needs to be built up again), so he's excited to be drawn from his mind-numbing work.

He's still kept up with his posts as Fortune Teller to give Gotham's vigilantes a nudge, but he also wants to be more hands-on.

When Tim makes his way to the Batcave, he finds both Dick and Jason down there, looking like they just finished sparring. "What's up?" he calls, curiously.

They look up, and Dick waves at Tim cheerily. Jason looks just as confused as Tim. When Tim makes his way over to them, Dick holds out a hand. "Wait here, guys. I need to get something," he says, running off to the lockers.

Jason and Tim exchange looks, and when Dick returns, he's holding a familiar uniform. Tim's eyes widen as he realizes what is going to happen. Holy. Shit. This needs to be *perfect* . Dick hadn't gotten to pass down Robin himself before, so Tim is kinda tearing up at the moment (not that he'll show it).

"Little Wing, I have decided that you're ready..If you want, Robin is yours. It was a way for me to fight for justice in my family's colors and my parent's nickname for me. I have moved on, but Robin is a mantle that I'd like to have passed down. Because we are also now family, I believe that Robin is just the thing for you. You want to help, to be Gotham's light, and I think Gotham would be lucky to have you as Robin," Dick monologues, smiling brightly and holding up the uniform like Simba.

Tim claps enthusiastically as Jason opens and closes his mouth like a fish. "But.." he stutters, "but what about.. Tim?"

Tim rolls his eyes. “Jason you’re older than me and would be a *way* better Robin,” he encourages. He then leans in and whispers in Jason’s ear, “I was your biggest fan when you were Robin. You were my favorite!” Jason blushes bright red as Tim grins excitedly.

“What are you waiting for??” Tim prompts, “Take it! If..you want that is..” Tim quickly backtracks realizing that Jason might not want to be Robin. He *died* as Robin for gods-sake (not that he knows. Tim still hasn’t told him and probably never will).

Jason nods vigorously and the cave erupts into cheers as he takes the uniform. Jason is grinning, but can’t help teasing, “I’ll definitely need a new uniform with pants though.”

Tim nods seriously in agreement, “Good idea.”

Dick pouts before turning to Tim. “Are you okay with this baby bird? I didn’t want to leave you out of it.”

Tim’s him a thumbs up, beaming. “Yeah! I’m so happy for you Jason!”, he replies. Suddenly he turns shy, pulling at the bottom of his shirt. “Can..I also help though? Maybe in the cave if not on patrol?”

“Hm..” Dick muses, “You would have to talk to B, but I’m sure he’ll be okay with it if you stay in the cave. I was out patrolling when I was your age, but he’s gotten more protective. Plus you’re a little genius, so we can use your help!”

Tim smirks. He may not be Robin, but he’s determined to still be in on the action.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 With great power comes great responsibility (and stress)

“B, Poison Ivy is en route to the harbor. Apparently, a gang has been dumping chemicals into the bay that’s harming the algae and coral. Normally, I wouldn’t mind her doling out some justice, but the gang meets near a hotel, so civilians could be caught in the crossfire,” Parakeet reports, glancing down at his notebook and sending coordinates. “I can try calling and warning the hotel staff, so everyone stays indoors with the doors and windows shut.”

“Copy that, Parakeet. Please make the call. We are on our way,” Batman responds as he swerves the Batmobile in the right direction.

Okay, so maybe Poison Ivy isn’t on her way yet.. but she will be soon, and the sooner Batman and Robin get there, the better. Tim a.k.a Parakeet (a reference to their use in fortune-telling) has taken on an Oracle type role, as Babs is still in the field as Batgirl and hopefully will continue for a long time if Tim has anything to say about it.

Every night, he takes note of what goes down, and then goes back in time to help guide and warn the bats. Sometimes, he even posts warnings on Twitter for civilians to clear the area to make their jobs easier as well. He’s especially careful to make sure that the villains don’t catch on, but even if they do, he just goes back in time again.

This has made most nights go smoothly, the bats’ injuries and casualties kept to a minimum. Tim is actually really proud of himself, even if he doesn’t get public credit. Public opinion of the bats is at an all time high.

“Parakeet, come in,” B’s voice crackles through the comm, “Robin and I are at the location, but Ivy is still not here. We are watching the gang from the rafters. Should we engage? Status on the nearby hotel?”

“The hotel staff has informed me that the hotel is secure. I recommend incapacitating the members of the gang now so it’s easier to negotiate with Ivy when she gets there. Worrying about both the gang and Ivy at the same time may be a little harder,” Parakeet suggests.

Originally, Batman and Robin had gotten there in the middle of a fight between Ivy and the gang members. Everyone but Ivy had been affected by cuddle pollen, and she got away with dumping many of them in Gotham’s disgusting bay before B was able to placate her with proper punishment for them (i.e. community service cleaning up the bay).

“Roger that, Parakeet!” Robin agrees, and Parakeet can hear the sounds of them knocking out the gang members swiftly. “All rounded up and tied up!” Robin chirps after a few minutes.

“I’ve informed the police of the situation,” Batman states before Parakeet can hear the doors to the warehouse slam open and Poison Ivy’s familiar voice.

Parakeet carefully monitors the negotiation, tense because this is now unknown territory. Eventually, Poison Ivy leaves after B’s promise to have them clean up the bay as punishment (even allowing her the opportunity to supervise), though not without blowing some cuddle pollen in the gang members’ direction.

Parakeet stretches his arms in relief. All in a night’s work.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Baby brothers are gremlins…but sometimes they’re *cute* gremlins.

Tim has been trying to figure out a way to break out his younger brother from the League of Assassins since he arrived at Wayne Manor. Unfortunately, when he is so young, Talia keeps his location under such tight security that Tim is not able to determine where exactly Damian is from Gotham, even with access to the Batcomputer. Escaping Gotham to go to Nanda Parbat is equally difficult for Tim to do. Ugh. Having a family that cares is so annoying.

Tim has tried to convince Bruce that there is something important in Nanda Parbat, but without divulging that he is Gotham’s Fortune Teller, it is hard to make Bruce believe that it is worth the risk. Bruce’ll probably think Tim is pranking him if he tells him the truth about Damian (it is nearing April after all). Therefore, it is up to Tim (and Jason because he insists that Tim can’t go alone and is the only one that knows about his power) to rescue three-year-old Damian.

Tim has painstakingly put together a plan to retrieve the baby bat, and the opportunity to put it into effect finally arrives.

Tim has been posting about the bats in Gotham for months in an attempt to gain Talia's attention. Anything to do with her "Beloved" always tends to rile her up. For example, he speculated that Batman is going to get Catwoman pregnant in the near future, and the replies he got from an "anonymous" account (@the_detectives_baby_mama) were positively scathing.

It seems to have reached a point where Talia is determined to kill Selina, either for herself or for Damian (whose heirship she likely sees as threatened by Selina's alleged unborn child). When Selina's body is discovered, Tim (who feels horrified and guilty) urgently screams the loudest and longest he has had to for a while.

Time to rethink how to play this.

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 @childlesscatlady I heard the justice league will find cat-like aliens called Flerkens. They look exactly like cats, but they can eat people and things with tentacles that shoot out of their mouth. Thought you'd be interested :) Might want to try going to Watchtower so you can adopt!

> **@childlesscatlady** RUNNING

Selina shows up at Wayne Manor 30 minutes later. Now that Tim can be assured of Selina's safety at either Wayne Manor or the Watchtower for a while, he can finally try drawing Ra's al Ghul out.

He knows Talia will be in Gotham hunting Selina for the next week or so, so he uses his knowledge about Ra's obsession with Lazarus Pits to lure him out of Nanda Parbat as well.

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 What is this glowing green liquid I just found?? I saw a half-dead reindeer fall in and walk out good as new 🤔

@immortaldemonhead Where is this? Specific coordinates will be helpful. Asking for a friend.

@ tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Go to 63.4452° N, 10.9052° E

With Ra's looking for a nonexistent Lazarus Pit in Norway and Talia leaving Nanda Parbat to kill her perceived competition (such a pick me 🙄), it should be a little easier to get to Damian.

The next part of the plan is setting up a base of operations where Bruce can't interfere. It has to be somewhere safe, so Bruce's paranoia doesn't make him visit unannounced.

Dick has spent the last couple years since he moved out of Wayne Manor shouting his independence for the whole neighborhood to hear. Bruce is now too scared to even visit the apartment unless invited by Dick in the fear of getting into an argument and not seeing Dick for months as was common before they reached a ceasefire.

This makes his apartment the perfect place to set up and the perfect cover for where they are. Tim and Jason decide to ask for a weekend sleepover at Dick's and will leave their trackers there when they're off to Nanda Parbat.

All it will take to get Dick to agree to cover for them is the promise that he would be the coolest older brother ever…and maybe a blow to their pride if he asks for a favor in return.

They use the excuse of an EPIC (!!) prank on Bruce as an explanation on why they need to hide from the other residents of Wayne Manor.

Dick pretty much takes that at face value (surprisingly), though they do have to convince him that it is better for him to stay in Bludhaven as their man in the chair in case they need assistance instead of flying to Pakistan with them.

Once the weekend arrives, the two of them pack up all of the gear they need, and Dick drives them to his apartment after the rescheduled Friday night dinner. Although Tim tried to insist he could drive them so Dick wouldn't have to borrow one of Bruce's cars, Jason categorically refused, citing trauma from the time Tim kidnapped him. The adults didn't even humor him.

After sleeping over for the night, Tim and Jason catch an early Saturday morning flight to Pakistan. The journey from the airport to Nanda Parbat is long and arduous. Tim is so tempted to scream and scrap this whole plan, but remembering Damian's fragile, hesitant smile at being allowed gentleness toward newborn stray kittens pushes him onwards. He's been through a whole lot worse before.

Jason seems just as tired as Tim, but he also seems used to pushing himself to the limits. He's survived in a lot worse conditions with a way more malnourished and weak body.

They tie their camels up about a half mile away from the League's base. Damian will love riding back on them, Tim's sure. He makes a note to allow Damian to feed them.

"Let me make the rounds to see where everyone is stationed, and I'll get back to you." Tim whispers to Jason who nods.

Tim then wanders through the base, drawing a map of where he runs into people, and cries out before they can attack him. When he finally finds Damian's room, he walks in on a nanny screeching as she's stabbed in the hand by a grumpy toddler sitting in a crib.

" *No, want sweets!"* he yells in the League's dialect.

Tim slowly closes the door before they can notice him.

Noting down where Damian is, Tim makes his way back through the League base and notes positions on the way back. He then stops at the kitchen to steal some honeyed dates (he remembers Damian loving them) and screams loud enough to get sent back to the camels.

Jason looks at the honeyed dates questioningly, but otherwise just reviews that map until he's satisfied.

The two brothers then ninja-run to the outside of the base, stealthily knocking out the guards at an entrance. They quickly steal their clothes and change into the League attire, strolling in as casually as possible (don't mind two kids just walking around an assassin base).

Once they make their way, unseen, to Damian's room, Tim waits for the sound of screeching before letting himself in.

" *We're here to relieve you of your duty to watch over Ibn al Xu'ffasch"* Tim states monotonously, face blank.

The nanny runs out before he even finishes, not even questioning his statement or looking to see who it is. Tim wonders if she'll be killed for abandoning the heir, then shrugs. If she's working for the League of Assassins she can't be all innocent, especially if she's trusted enough to look after Damian.

He then shifts his focus to Damian, who is glaring at the two of them suspiciously. He's the angriest toddler Tim has ever seen, but Tim finally understands Dick's obsession with cuddling, spoiling, and teasing him and Jason. Tim finally feels like an older brother.

He is overtaken with an intense feeling of cuteness aggression. Damian's anger makes his chubby cheeks puff out even more, and his flushed face, scrunched up eyebrows, and pout complete the picture of adorableness. Man, his little brother really is precious.

Tim never really noticed before on account of the murder attempts, but Damian's likeness to Bruce and the intensity of his glare framed by a childlike face really capture Tim's heart.

Tim would literally let Damian kill him if it would make him happy.

Jason makes a sound of amusement beside him, snapping Tim out of his insanity. At the sound, Damian brandishes his bloody dagger.

“ *No!* ” he yells again.

In response, Tim lifts up the plate of honeyed dates, capturing Damian’s attention. The three-year-old drops the dagger and reaches out his arms in demand. “ *Gimme!* ” he orders.

In his previous life, Tim would have hated the obnoxious demand, but it loses its edge when coming from such a chibi-sized Damian.

“ *Here you are, baby bat!* ” Tim sing-songs, smiling sweetly. He approaches the crib and lifts Damian with his right arm, letting him grab the dates from the plate in Tim’s left hand.

Damian looks confused by the touch at first (much like Tim was when he first started out as Robin), but the touch-starved baby bat is quickly distracted by stuffing his mouth with the sweets.

Jason shudders at Tim’s tone, but raises his hand in surrender when Damian pauses to glare at him.

At Tim’s request, Jason picks up Damian’s dagger and wraps it in cloth, storing it in his backpack. There’s no toys in Damian’s room, so he was likely only given the dagger to play with. They probably won’t give it back to him for a while (and he’ll have plenty of toys to play with when they get to Gotham), but when he’s old enough, he’ll probably appreciate having it.

With Damian sufficiently placated, the brothers make their way out of the base undetected.

Damian doesn’t even notice until they leave the base. He looks around wide-eyed, probably not having left the compound in a while if not ever. He’d finished off the plate in minutes, so Tim stores it in his bag, and the three brothers make the trek back to their camels. Well..Tim

and Jason trek back. Damian leans into Tim, looking around imperiously from his arms like the little prince he is.

When they reach the camels, Damian makes a soft sound of excitement, shifting around and looking up at Tim hopefully, though he doesn't ask if he can pet the camels. He probably got scolded (at the very least) for loving animals the way he does.

Tim walks right up to his camel, taking Damian's tiny fist that had been clenched onto his robe and moving it to brush through the camel's fur. Damian makes another sound of excitement, looking a lot less angry than he did at first. Tim even notices the beginnings of a smile.

Tim can't help himself and quickly pecks the toddler's cheek. Damian looks at him curiously, but otherwise doesn't comment or protest so Tim takes that as a win.

"Aww, I wanna do that!" Jason proclaims. He's changed out of the League uniform and into his travelling clothes, looking at the two of them fondly. "Here, let me hold him while you change," he offers.

Tim nods and passes Damian over, but Jason jumps, crying out, "He bit me!!" He holds out Damian like a feral cat, and Damian struggles in his grasp, trying to lean down and bite his hands. He looks angry again, and he's reaching out his arms for Tim to take him back.

"Ow! He's a demon!" Jason complains.

"An *adorable* demon," Tim corrects.

Damian is still a feral child, but at least he's not a feral *assassin* child.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Ugh. April's coming up. I hate allergies 🤧

If it was hard travelling alone, making their way back to the airport with a toddler is *so* much worse. Damian is understandably cranky, and he will *not* allow Tim to let him go, throwing tantrums and biting at Jason when Tim needs to hand him over. They tried letting him run around to play *once* and he ran away so fast that it took ages to catch him. For someone with such short legs he can really book it.

The only thing that gets him to calm down and behave is the opportunity to feed the camels. He gets a small smile on his face every time Tim hands him the food and the camels eat from the palm of his small hand.

By the time the group gets to the airport, they are *exhausted* . Thankfully, Damian is so tuckered out that he sleeps the whole plane ride back (they all do).

When they arrive back at Dick's apartment, Dick opens the door for them worriedly.

"Where were you?? I couldn't reach you and you were gone for *so long* . I thought I lost my little siblings and that I would lose B's trust forever," Dick frets, looking over them as they enter the apartment.

He freezes when he sees the lump in Tim's arms glaring back at him. "Is that..a *baby* ?!" he cries out, shocked.

"Not a baby, he's three," Tim says.

"That's beside the point!" Dick replies, "How did you *acquire* the three-year-old??"

"We stole him from the League of Assassins," Jason informs him, "He's better off here, don't worry."

“ *Don’t worry??* ” Dick repeats, voices going high, “ *Why* did you steal him?”

“The League’s no place for a child, first of all. Second of all, he’s B’s son,” Tim says seriously.

There’s a pause. Then Dick bursts out laughing. “I see what you’re doing,” he gasps through giggles, “This is the prank you have planned for B. I rate it a 10/10. You almost got me.”

Jason and Tim exchange exasperated glances. This is what they get for lying to Dick about the prank.

“This is not a prank, Dickhead!” Jason yells, “Look at him. He looks just like the old man.”

Dick glances at Damian, who has buried himself further into Tim’s arms, unnerved by the man’s loud laughter, and sobers up.

“How did you find a kid that looks just like B?” he asks.

“Bruce fucked Talia al Ghul, that’s how,” Jason states bluntly.

“ *Jason!* ” Dick cries out scandalized while Tim quickly covers Damian’s ears.

It’s too late though.

“FUCK!” Damian screeches angrily, breaking his silence to say that one word. Tim swears toddlers can automatically pick out curse words.

Tim glares at Jason, who is starting to look scared. Good.

“You’re going to have to explain to B why Damian’s first English word is ‘fuck’,” Tim warns.

Jason pouts, grumbling. Dick is still looking shell-shocked.

“Oh. my. God. I have another baby brother??” he squeals happily once he processes the information. He goes to grab Damian, likely to give him a hug, but when he reaches out, Damian bites his hand. Dick yelps, jerking his hand back and clutching it to his chest.

Honestly, it’s looking like the only person Damian tolerates right now is Tim, and if being Damian’s favorite sibling isn’t an ego boost, Tim doesn’t know what is. Dick was 100% Damian’s favorite in his previous life while Tim was his least favorite, so Damian preferring Tim makes him feel *so* smug (and happy). Eventually, Damian will love all of them, but being first choice makes Tim want to tear up.

“Sorry, Dick. I think he’s still getting used to people. I don’t think he was held much in the League, if at all,” Tim says apologetically at his pouting oldest brother.

Dick’s puppy-dog eyes go sad at that. He nods decisively, “I’ll hug him as much as he’ll let me.”

The four brothers spend Sunday night at Dick’s apartment. It’s so nice to have all his siblings back together again, Tim has to cry in the bathroom for a little bit. In the morning, Dick drives them all back to Wayne Manor. Damian has to sit in Tim’s lap because they don’t have a car seat, and he looks out the window the whole way, screeching every time they pass a car with a dog peeking out of the window.

When they arrive at the manor, they look at each other nervously. Here goes nothing.

When they enter, they are greeted by Alfred whose eyebrows shoot up high on his forehead, the only evidence of his surprise.

“Young Masters. Who is our young guest?” he inquires.

“Hey Alfie!” Jason chirps, “This is Damian, B’s son!”

Alfred, who is the only one of the group to have known Bruce as a child and is never fazed, inspects Damian closely and nods, believing them right away. He looks pleased, and Tim exhales a sigh of relief. One down, one more to go (arguably the hardest one).

Damian is looking back at Alfred curiously from the safety of Tim’s arms, seemingly fascinated by his mustache. Alfred leads the group down to the Batcave where Bruce is hunched over the Batcomputer.

“Master Bruce,” Alfred calls, “Your sons are home. All four of them.”

Bruce turns around and waves blearily at them, his sleep deprivation causing a delay in processing. He turns back around, but then jolts when Alfred’s statement gets through to him.

He spins around, almost falling off his chair, suddenly alert. He scans the group until his eyes rest on Damian who is looking at him in awe. Looks like Damian will always look up to Bruce no matter the timeline.

Bruce stares for a long moment then sighs pinching his nose. “I was expecting an April Fools joke, but you have really gone above and beyond this year. Please send him back to his family,” he requests tiredly.

Wait, what?

Tim checks his phone for the date and trades a wide-eyed look with Jason. They both hadn’t realized it was April 1st. No wonder Dick believed the prank excuse so easily.

“It’s not an April Fools joke!” Dick says, “I thought it was too, but they’re being serious.”

“It’s just bad timing,” Tim hurries to explain, “We didn’t realize the date, but Damian *is* your son.”

“Nice try,” Bruce responds sardonically.

Tim groans. “Do a DNA test and you’ll believe us. He’s your kid with Talia al Ghul! This was the important thing in Nanda Parbat I was telling you about!” he insists.

Bruce sighs placatingly and pulls out a swab. “Alright, I’ll humor you,” he says.

Damian fights the swab at first, but submits to it reluctantly (and furiously) when Tim does it.

When the test result comes out, Bruce stares at it, stunned. He glares at Tim, “Did you hack the Batcomputer for this prank?” he accuses.

“ *No!* ” Tim replies, offended (okay that is something he would totally do).

“Denial isn’t just a river in Egypt, old man. You better believe it,” Jason interjects, annoyed.

“If I may, Master Bruce, the youngest master looks just like you as a toddler,” Alfred informs him.

Bruce examines Damian in a new light and tentatively brushes his fingers lightly against the three-year-old’s soft cheek. Damian yawns, eyelids drooping. He snuggles against Tim’s shoulder and everyone ‘aww’s at the sweet sight. “Fuck,” Damian mumbles sleepily.

“ *Jason!* ” Dick whisper-shrieks. Jason groans and glares at Damian mutinously. “Really, Demon? Throwing me under the bus? You really don’t like me, and you know what? I don’t like you!” Jason whines.

“Shh” Tim hisses, not wanting to disturb the toddler. Alfred looks on disapprovingly while Bruce just pinches his nose again. Jason meekly (for him at least) apologises after that.

Alfred sets up a nursery at light speed (how he found a crib and rocking chair so fast, Tim doesn’t know), and Tim lays Damian down to sleep. The family spends the rest of the day recounting Tim and Jason’s adventure and getting the manor ready for Damian. The boys get plenty of scolding from all the adults for going off on their own as an eleven and thirteen-year-old. They’re grounded from patrol for a month and Dick says they owe him a favor for putting him through all that stress, but Tim thinks it’s worth it.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 It’s a boy!!!! 🥳

The next morning, Tim looks for Damian because he’s not in his crib and finds him snuggled into Bruce’s warm, protective embrace, the two of them fast asleep on Bruce’s bed. He smiles, knowing that Damian is going to be just fine.

Chapter End Notes

This chapter focused on Jason, Tim, and Damian joining Wayne Manor! The family is now physically complete, but that doesn't mean there's not more work for Tim to do 👀

The irony of Selina's @ being childlesscatlady when she was killed for possibly being pregnant was completely unintentional, but I love it lol (I just wanted to make a reference to that stupid quote. iykyk)

Also for those of you who didn't already look up the coordinates, they lead to Hell (in Norway)

Hope you enjoyed this chapter!!

Stopping a Bird from Flying the Coop

Chapter Summary

Trigger warning: Joker 😅

Chapter Notes

This is a little more serious of a chapter (you can probably guess why). I still tried to add lighthearted moments tho!

Happy Reading!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 How to defend your brother from murder charges?

@im_fast_as_fuck_boi Umm are you and your family okay?

@blonde_conspiracy_theorist Lol, this is normal for Gotham dude

@im_fast_as_fuck_boi Oop sorry I'm in Central City. I just got here from an apocalyptic future so I'm still figuring things out.

@eat_the_rich Are all this account's followers kooky?

@blonde_conspiracy_theorist omg can I hire you as a fortune teller?

Jason's fifteenth birthday is bittersweet for Tim. It's been an amazing three years of laughter, growth, and love for Tim since he joined the Wayne family. However, on this day, Tim feels

doused with a bucket of cold water when he remembers Jason's death at the hands of the Joker this coming year.

As an outside observer at the time, Tim never really knew the inner workings of what caused Jason to go off on his own in Ethiopia, and it was always too sore a subject to ask anyone. Jason liked to be cruel with his reminders, but he never really went into detail about the cause.

This causes Tim to have heightened tension the weeks following Jason's birthday, waiting for the shoe to drop and hoping it's something he can prevent.

It finally happens one seemingly innocuous patrol. Parakeet is sipping his last coffee of the night (darn Alfred for setting a limit) when Robin is shouting through the comms in anger at what sounds like a rapist. *Valid.* Parakeet thinks, looking forward to the justice that is about to be served.

Unfortunately, justice seems to be served accidentally when there's a yelp and thud. Batman is bellowing down the comms, "ROBIN!"

Parakeet jerks up in worry. "Report!" he cries, "What's wrong?" He can't gain a visual of where they are.

"Parakeet, call paramedics to the scene. A suspect is unresponsive and no pulse is detected. We'll be discussing this back at the cave Robin," Batman states gravely. He sounds more serious than usual, which is saying a lot, and Parakeet gets a sick feeling in his stomach.

"I didn't kill him!" Robin yells, "He tripped and fell!"

There's a sigh, and Batman says, "We'll discuss this later. For now, focus on helping the victim."

When the two get back to the Batcave, there is a heavy tension between them. “Parakeet, thank you for your help today. I need to have a private discussion with Robin about what occurred on patrol. Please give us privacy,” B requests monotonously.

Parakeet and Robin trade wide-eyed looks and Parakeet tries to give Robin a reassuring smile, but he looks away, obviously nervous.

When Tim gets back up to the manor, he can hear muffled yelling echo from behind the grandfather clock. He debates if he should just go back in time now and try to prevent this whole altercation from happening, but something stops him.

Instinctually, Tim somehow suspects that this might have been the starting point leading towards Jason’s death. He ponders on whether to see how this all plays out and prevent the death with more information or if he should stop this right now and hope that Ethiopia or the Joker won’t happen anymore.

He can’t put anything to chance. He *needs* to be completely sure on how to proceed. It was hard losing his Robin. It’ll be even harder losing his brother if he can’t save him. Tim knows that Jason will be revived and he’ll stalk his grave every day for that possibility, but he can’t shake the vision of rage in Jason’s pit-green eyes when looking upon Tim. He can’t handle that hate anymore, especially when he’s had Jason’s love.

Tim decides to head to his room, waiting for the sound of Bruce and Jason going to bed as well. He eventually hears Jason’s angry footsteps stomp into his room and the door slam. Tim slides out of bed and patters across the hallway, softly knocking.

“Go the fuck away!” Jason yells.

“Jason it’s me,” Tim replies in case Jason thinks he’s Bruce. Jason just grunts in response (very Batman- like, though he’d probably hate the comparison right now).

Tim opens the door and finds Jason laying face down in his bed curled under his blankets. Only his head of hair sticks out, ruffled from the windy Gotham air.

“What’s going on, Jay?” Tim asks quietly, climbing onto the bed and flopping onto the blanket burrito.

A sniffle sounds in the silent room, and Jason chokes out, “Stupid rapist tripped and fell when I was fighting him, but Batman didn’t see what happened and thinks I pushed him or something. I didn’t! I’m not a killer!” he insists defensively.

“I know you’re not, Jay,” Tim replies confidently. At least not yet. Tim is determined to keep it that way in this lifetime.

Tim’s trust seems to make Jason boneless with relief, full on sobs now heaving from his shaking body. Tim quickly snuggles under the covers with him and holds him comfortingly.

“Can’t you go back in time and fix this?” Jason wails, “I don’t want my dad to hate me.”

“I will,” Tim promises, “just give me time.”

The next morning, Tim tries to defend Jason to Bruce, but Bruce seems reluctant to believe him as Tim wasn’t there. Tim burns in anger at the thought that Bruce wouldn’t trust his own son, but then takes a breath to think about it rationally. Bruce tends to separate Bruce Wayne and Batman, so he might not have realised the impact his disappointment is having on Jason.

Before Tim can explain, however, Alfred herds him out the door for school. Looking back, Tim remembers that Bruce’s dark circles looked extra dark that morning.

The following days show not much improvement despite Tim’s best efforts at conflict resolution. He’s reminded strongly of Bruce’s fights with Dick and how they just wouldn’t *talk* to one another. He is tempted to get them to make up through his previous methods, but it wouldn’t work with Jason knowing his identity.

Damian also seems to sense something is wrong. The usually independent six-year-old turns uncharacteristically clingy, wanting everyone to pay him attention and be in the same room together. Dick tries to help, but his work and patrol keep him too busy to visit very often, and phone calls don't seem to have the same effect.

It's been a week of this weird tension when Tim finds Jason packing a bag.

"Where are you going?" he asks, startling his older brother.

"Away from here," Jason grumbles, "If Bruce doesn't want me anymore, I'm going to find a parent that does. Turns out my mom was actually my stepmom and I have a biological mom working in an aid camp in Ethiopia."

Tim's heart drops.

"Maybe you should try to talk to Bruce before you go alone," Tim tries to convince him desperately, "He'll probably be able to help arrange a meeting with her. It'll be dangerous to go by yourself."

Jason snorts. "That's so hypocritical. You literally wanted to free an assassin child on your own," he sneers.

"Yeah, and you went with me because you thought it would be too dangerous for me alone. Plus I literally have a time travel power. Maybe this is me telling you that you shouldn't go because something bad happens in Ethiopia," Tim protests.

But Jason is too angry to be rational. "Whatever. If you won't fix this, then I'll fix it *my* way," he grunts, rolling his eyes. He's out the window before Tim can say anything else.

A few days later, Tim wakes up to Bruce's familiar devastation. Apparently, Jason had gone to meet his biological mom, Sheila, even though Bruce had told him to stay put while Batman went after the Joker. She had sold him out to the Joker.

Tim closes his eyes when he hears. He's sick of parents letting their kids down. Poor Jason just wanted someone to love him unconditionally like a parent should. Bruce does, but it's hard for him to show it.

Tim sucks on a throat lozenge in preparation for his haunted house scream as he makes note of the timeline, coordinates of the fight with Felipe Garzonas, and Sheila Haywood's information. He needs to make sure there is solid evidence of Jason's innocence and Sheila's guilt.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Joker has decided to take a vacation in Ethiopia. It's sure to be mind-blowing!

@hope_you_die_of_laughter ah ah ah timmy boy my plans are not to be shared unless you want your mind blown too! HAHAHAHAHA

@eat_the_rich Really dude? You're reusing his pun? That's not funny.

@random_gothamite OP is SO much funnier.

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Idk what you're talking about. I just thought you wanted in on Ethiopian coffee. I heard it's delicious.

@hope_you_die_of_laughter little timmy wants to hide behind a screen but if he wants to be mean he should come out and face me like a queen. no one is funnier than me ~ if you think they are you'll soon find their body at sea

@purple_waffles 🙄

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 I'm sure all of Gotham (and the world) has been waiting for this moment for a long time! Our little murderous jokester will kick the bucket a little too hard in Ethiopia and never return.

@blonde_conspiracy_enthusiast OMG IS THIS REAL??

@eat_the_rich You better not be joking.

@electric_bluebird 😱🥳

@hope_you_die_of_laughter nice try i'm not stopping HAHAHAHA

@Not_Batman Any details would be appreciated.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Hot chocolate is a miracle cure ☕

Tim appears two days before the fateful patrol and immediately hurries to prepare. He begs off school (sorry Jason, but it's for your own good) and heads to an electronics store to purchase security cameras.

He then looks up the coordinates on his GPS and sneaks off to the location of Felipe Garzonas' death. After that, setting up the cameras is relatively easy, though it's harder to remain hidden in the daylight. He sets them up in all angles, so there's a very rare chance he will miss what happens. He can always go back and change the angle and location if he doesn't catch it.

Once the cameras are secure (and hidden), Tim makes his way back to school. He needs access to the Batcomputer to really do an in depth background check on Sheila Haywood, so he waits until patrol. He still has the notes for tonight's patrol, so it goes smoothly while he spends most of his time researching Jason's bio mom.

What he finds makes him so angry. She was a doctor who had to leave Gotham after botching an illegal operation resulting in the death of a teenage girl. She is now working at a refugee camp that she is embezzling from. Tim pulls up records of the Joker blackmailing her over the phone, and her trading expensive supplies for Joker gas. Why Joker chose to attack Ethiopian refugees Tim has no idea, but it's probably because he knows her connection to Robin (and because he's pure evil). Everything Tim pulls up about her morals (or lack there of) shows that she and Willis really deserved each other.

When the patrol finally arrives, Tim is tense with nerves. He's decided that he's not going to stop the event from happening, but instead present Bruce with the security footage. Tim believes that it'll be better for Jason and B's relationship in the long term if they talk out their differences now instead of having tension build up (he also doesn't really feel like saving the rapist's life - it was a freak accident 🤷).

When Batman and Robin get back, Parakeet refuses to leave and instead shows them the security footage of Garzonas falling on his own and Robin trying to save him. Robin slumps with relief and B's eyes soften.

Still, the fact that B even suspected him seems to make Robin uncomfortable, so Parakeet urges them to talk about it, "B, you should learn from your experience with Nightwing. It's only going to make it worse if you don't talk about your reasoning."

B turns to Robin and takes off his cowl so he can make eye contact with his son. "I will love you no matter what. You will always be my son. It's just..I'm worried about how angry you are when fighting suspects. I know you have a lot of unresolved issues with your time on the street, and I understand why you are feeling this way. However, it's one thing to want Gotham to change and another thing to try and be the unilateral authority on the punishment they deserve. We are not the judge, jury, or executioner. We just arrest them and let the courts handle it," Bruce explains.

"Yeah, like corruption isn't rampant in the courts. Guys like Garzonas are always set free to hurt other people because they're rich and powerful! That's not justice!" Jason yells, having

also removed his mask.

"I know Jason, we can't fix everything at once," B sighs, "But as both Bruce Wayne and Batman, I am working on dismantling Gotham's corruption. I've already made huge steps with CPS ever since you told me how bad it was, you know that."

Jason grunts, still not looking happy.

Bruce sighs again, and tentatively reaches to brush a curl behind Jason's ear. "Jaylad, maybe you should go talk to Dinah for a little bit. There's no shame in doing so. Being a hero is hard, and you've already been through a lot before I took you in. Even Dick's talked to her before and also has mandatory counseling as a cop."

Before Jason can get defensive, Tim interjects, "Counseling can be helpful to everybody, Jason, you're not crazy if you talk to Dinah. You're just human."

Jason snorts. "Like you've ever talked to a shrink, Tim. Would you talk to Dinah about your abandonment issues?" Jason asks scathingly. Tim knows this is a defense mechanism and doesn't react to the bait. He's still mentally an adult and he won't react to a teenager's insults (even if they are true).

"I would if it would help show you that therapy is okay," he states honestly.

Jason falters, obviously not expecting that answer. "Fine," he huffs.

In a rare move, probably instigated by pride, Bruce pulls the both of them into a warm, strong hug. They melt into him and the three stay like that for a while before the cave entrance opens and a sleepy voice calls, "Dad? Tim? Jason?"

They break apart and notice Damian on the stairs, rubbing his sleepy eyes and dressed in his cow pajamas, a stuffed camel hanging from his hand.

“Damian, why are you still awake?” Bruce asks worriedly, walking over with Damian’s older brothers right behind him.

Bruce picks the six-year-old up and rests him on his hip. Damian is getting kinda old for it and Bruce’s genes make him tall for his age, but Bruce is also strong enough to probably carry all of his children comfortably if he wanted to, even Dick.

“No one came upstairs when you were supposed to,” Damian pouts, obviously worried, but not wanting to admit it. Tim smiles fondly. Damian has everyone in the Manor kiss him goodnight before patrol starts, but he still manages to want more attention. They usually check on him before going to sleep themselves. It’s honestly so sweet that Damian is getting the touch and love that he deserves in this timeline. His soft hands are not calloused or stained with blood like Before.

Damian, as the baby in the family, is spoiled beyond belief, but this time, it’s not in the obnoxious way the League raised him but in the way every youngest is spoiled.

“Want hot chocolate?” Tim asks, “I think we all need it.”

Damian nods enthusiastically, reaching for Jason and Tim’s hands while still in Bruce’s arms. Their clingy monkey has warmed up immensely to the whole family. Though he and Jason still bicker the most, they would just as often be found reading and drawing together. Tim and Dick dote on him a lot so he likes spending time with them, and he *loves* cuddling with Bruce. He enjoys helping Alfred around the manor as well, looking up to the stoic man.

The manor has also been overrun with pets, as they were used to bribe Damian into liking everyone once they learned how much he likes animals. Bruce got him a German shepherd named Ace, Dick got him a Great Dane named Titus, Alfred got him a tuxedo cat that Damian dubbed Alfred the cat, and Jason (the insane motherfucker that he is) got Damian Batcow (he might have been Damian’s favorite for a full year before Tim won the title back). Tim literally thought he wouldn’t see that cow for *years*, if ever, but he guesses time has a way of correcting itself. Tim, of course, needed to upstage the rest of the family to regain his position as favorite sibling, and thus, Goliath rejoined the family. Tim, having been desensitized to having Goliath around, laughed as the rest of the family, bar Damian, was horrified.

The four of them make their way out of the cave still in the weird knot that they've found themselves in (Damian refuses to let go of Tim and Jason's hands) and sprawl across a living room couch. Jason goes to make hot chocolate (he's the only one of them allowed in the kitchen) and the family relaxes in each other's company. Eventually, Ace and Titus join them and the family is content for what Tim feels like is the first time in a while.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Sometimes people aren't meant to be parents (though for some reason they are always the ones that reproduce)

Tim decides to be proactive about Jason's bio mom. He approaches Jason a week after the Garzonas incident. "Hey Jaybird! Can I talk to you about something real quick? It has to do with my you-know-what." Tim asks.

Jason smirks, "Your diarrhea?"

Tim smacks his shoulder in exasperation. Jason cackles, falling off his chair (okay Tim pushed him).

"We should go visit your old place, there's something important there that you need to know," Tim tells him seriously.

Jason sobers up fast at that and gives Tim a searching look. "Alright.." he drawls skeptically.

The two of them skip school (much to Jason's dismay, the nerd) and take an Uber to the outskirts of Crime Alley (the driver refused to go into the area). When they get to Jason's old apartment, they sneak in through the window after checking that no one was in there.

Tim asks Jason where they kept all the important documents, and Jason leads him to a loose board in the master bedroom's closet floor. He pulls out a few documents and notebooks. Tim finds Jason's birth certificate with the blotted-out name of his mother.

He takes a deep breath, and slowly explains to a shocked Jason, "I know this may be very unexpected for you, but if you look at the birth certificate, your mom's name starts with an 'S' not a 'C'. This doesn't discount Catherine as your mom. She still is because she was the one who raised you, but in my future, you get curious about your bio mom and try to find her. It…uh..doesn't go well."

Tim looks at Jason nervously. He didn't know if being blunt was going to help or backfire. Jason slowly takes the birth certificate from Tim, staring at it and clenching his fists until the paper crumbles slightly. "Who..is she?" Jason asks softly, scarily calm at the moment. He feels like a ticking time bomb (A/N: see what i did there 😏) to Tim right now.

Tim picks up Willis' address book, flipping to the correct page that displays the name, 'Sheila Haywood.' Jason stares at that for a while too. He mouths the name, seemingly trying to make sense of its connection to him.

Tim clears his throat, trying to get Jason's attention. "I didn't think it would be right to keep this from you, but I think you're better off if you never meet her. I'll show you the evidence I collected, but..she's not a good person, Jason. Not like Catherine," Tim admits.

"Great," Jason scoffs, "I have two shitty bio parents. Guess I'm just scum all around."

" *No*, Jason!" Tim cries, dropping the book and pulling his older brother into his arms. "You are an *amazing* person despite who your parents are. Bruce and Catherine wouldn't love you as their son if you weren't so awesome. *I* love you." Jason sniffles and finally returns Tim's hug.

"I'll show you the evidence to satisfy your curiosity," Tim resolves, "But you have to *promise* me to not go after her, especially without us as your backup. The..last time you went after her..you.. *died* ." The last sentence is hard to get out, but Tim *has* to say it. Jason needs to know how high the stakes are.

Jason sucks in a sharp breath, tensing up, then he consciously makes himself relax. “Okay, Timbo,” he replies.

After seeing Sheila’s medical malpractice, embezzlement, and interaction with the Joker and hearing Tim’s recount of what happened in his previous timeline, Jason decides to let his connection to his biological parents go.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Coffee tastes bitter, but revenge tastes sweet

Tim hops off the plane with a skip in his step. He feels weirdly rejuvenated after the long ass flight he just took. The sun is burning bright overhead as he rents a pickup truck and drives to a decrepit warehouse in the middle of nowhere.

Tim whistles as he pulls the large broken piano he had bought at a flea market on the way off the truck’s bed. He drags it in front of the only entrance of the warehouse, and clicks the lock of the entrance door into place. He sits on the bench and starts to play a discordant melody on the worn instrument.

Crazed laughter and a woman’s scream seem to echo from the warehouse, but most of it is drowned out by the haunting melody. After Tim slams his hands down on the keys in a dramatic finale, he sweeps off the piano bench and bows to an imaginary audience. He skips back to the truck and drives off in the direction he came in. A loud explosion behind him breaks the peaceful silence of the desert expanse, but Tim continues on unfazed, driving off into the sunset.

The bodies of Sheila Haywood and the Joker are confirmed by a stunned Batman less than ten minutes later on the comms.

Tim always knew he had evil mastermind potential. It’s only right that he uses it for good. He's not taking any chances for more Joker related crimes, Barbara’s paralysis included. Tim’s not one for victim blaming, but it’s really Sheila and the Joker’s fault for being in a shady warehouse they rigged with explosives if you think about it.

He steps off a plane back in Gotham not even two days after he left, sipping coffee he got from the stewardess and swinging a duffel bag filled with bags of delicious Ethiopian coffee beans.

Chapter End Notes

This is Jason's chapter! Tim is able to get him to stay home and eventually live!

What do you guys think about Tim deciding to kill the Joker? I think his powers make it easier for him to cross the line. And again..supervillain potential.

Hope you liked it!

Migrating Home

Chapter Summary

Jack and Janet Drake make an appearance.

Chapter Notes

I'll be honest, this one's a little shorter because there's not much action, and it's really a deep dive into Tim's issues with his parents that carry over to the Waynes who need to reassure him that he's part of their family. I believe this is the most serious out of all the chapters, but I felt it was important to include.

CW: Nothing happens to anyone, but Jack just makes implications as to why Bruce is fostering Tim (implication of SA of a minor).

I hope you like this chapter!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 “ If I was wrong in yielding to persuasion once, remember that it was to persuasion exerted on the side of safety, not of risk. When I yielded, I thought it was to duty; but no duty could be called in aid here.” - Jane Austen (from the novel, *Persuasion*)

In the six years since Darkseid sent him back in time, Tim had never run into Jack and Janet Drake.

Three months after Bruce had gained permanent custody and taken him in, Tim’s parents had been arrested upon arrival back in Gotham. They were so disconnected that they didn’t suspect a thing until Commissioner Gordon was waiting for them as they exited the plane.

Jack and Janet ended up only having to pay a fine for their criminal neglect and child endangerment (stupid corruption), but the damage to their reputation had been done. The two of them refused to spare a modicum of attention on Tim as revenge, instead continuing their

travels and hoping their silent treatment would reflect their disappointment and anger (it wasn't anything new to Tim).

It is because of this that Tim thought they would never come back into his life. That they would live separate lives from him, the bridges burned.

But a month after his sixteenth birthday, he exits Gotham Academy and finds Jack Drake leaning against a bright red Porsche. Tim pauses, wondering if he can go back inside before he's noticed. Jason has theater club today, so the two of them are usually picked up later. Tim either stays in the library or goes to the store across the street for a snack while waiting for him to finish.

It is one of the days where Tim is craving a frozen pizza with marshmallow fluff, gummy bears, and hot sauce, so he's headed out to the store. Seeing his sperm donor with none of the Waynes to back him up has a pit forming in his stomach.

He tries to turn back, but it's too late. "Timothy!" Jack calls out. Tim sucks in a breath. He hasn't heard that voice so long, even longer than when he was sent to the past. He had been dead two years at that point.

"Hey, bud, how are you?" he asks, his voice getting closer. Tim's eyes are stuck on his feet, which are rooted to the ground. He's unable to escape, but trying to anyway.

Eventually, he sees fancy business shoes step up in his field of vision. He's frozen, his hands clenched tightly in the straps of his backpack. He has no idea what to do. For the first time, Tim doesn't feel like the adult he mentally is. He feels his body's age, just a scared kid.

"Timothy," Jack repeats, clearing his throat, "do you think your mom and I could talk to you for a moment? It's important."

Those are the first words his supposed dad has spoken to him after everything that happened between them. Tim knows they haven't spoken to him for close to seven years, but Jack acts like that distance had never happened, like he's just a normal dad who picks up his kid from school everyday.

Tim forces his head up to look over Jack's shoulder. Janet Drake can be seen in the passenger seat of the Porsche, looking cold and uninterested (her normal resting bitch face), probably expecting Tim to come to her. Neither of his parents seem to acknowledge the pain they put Tim through. Tim snorts internally. They probably think *he* owes *them* an apology.

Tim debates screaming right then and there. He can just wait in the library and walk out of the school with Jason, straight to Alfred. He doesn't even have to acknowledge them. He can force them to wait for him, like they had him do for the majority of his life.

He only hesitates because he's curious what they want to talk to him about. They haven't tried to contact him for years, so whatever it is, it must be important. He knows that once they set their mind on something, it's impossible to set them off course. They'll just keep coming after him until he hears them out.

"What?" he finally sighs, looking at Jack.

Jack frowns in disapproval, "That's not very respectful, Timothy. You shouldn't talk to your parents that way." he scolds.

"I don't," Tim retorts.

Jack sighs, "I know we haven't reached out to you in a while, Timothy, but that's really your fault. If you hadn't reported us, then we would have had the time to talk to you. As it is, Drake Industries isn't doing very well right now because *you* couldn't keep private matters private."

Wow. Gaslight. Gatekeep. Girlboss.

"Um..I'd think you're the one that broke the law. I had nothing to do with this. You should have known if you leave a ten year old on his own, people would eventually notice…" Tim reasons dubiously.

“Now, Timothy. We did that because we thought you were a responsible, well behaved little boy, but I can see now that we were wrong,” Jack accuses.

Tim sighs again. “If you’re just going to insult me, I’ll be leaving,” he says, moving to get around him.

“Wait!” Jack grabs his wrist tightly and Tim flinches.

“Just…come with us to a restaurant for a little bit. There’s just one small thing we need to talk about,” Jack pleads.

“Umm, I’m not letting you take me anywhere. You could kidnap me,” Tim deadpans, raising an eyebrow.

“We’re your *parents* , Timothy!” Jack emphasizes, raising his voice.

“Parents can still kidnap their kids. I’m not in your custody,” Tim replies.

Jack starts dragging Tim to the car, while Tim tries to fight his hand off. “Stop!” Tim yells.

“Timothy, stop being dramatic,” Janet’s voice sounds. She’s exited the car now and is crossing her arms disapprovingly.

“No! I will get a restraining order against you if you even try getting me in that car!” Tim threatens, on the verge of screaming.

Janet holds her hand up to Jack who stops dragging Tim, but doesn’t let go of his wrist.

“Timothy,” she starts, with a false sweetness in her voice, “we want to fight for custody of you again.”

Tim freezes his attempts to get free. “Wh-what do you mean?” he asks shakily.

“Drake Industries’ reputation has collapsed and it is struggling, in part because of your actions. We want you to take responsibility for that and ask to be put back with us. If you show forgiveness and we promise that we’ve changed and will arrange care for you, that would help all of us. You want your inheritance don’t you?” Janet commands more than requests.

This time Tim can’t hold in his snort. “I think I’ll have a bigger inheritance from Bruce Wayne, especially if you’re struggling financially,” he says wryly.

Janet sneers cruelly. “You think you’ll get any of Bruce Wayne’s inheritance? The only one of those brats that will get his inheritance is the biological one. You’re a burden, and I’m sure Brucie Wayne didn’t take you in because he loves you,” she snarls.

Jack guffaws, adding, “He probably wanted you for other reasons right?” He nudges Tim suggestively. It’s horrifying how he can joke about his own son getting sexually abused, but the Drakes were never known for their empathy (or any emotion really).

Tim tries shrinking away from them, but the blows keep coming. “You were okay on your own, right Timothy? We aren’t asking much from you. You just need to give the illusion that you’ve forgiven us and are in our custody again. You can go back to those Waynes when we’re gone, given you keep it secret, not that you’re any good at that,” Janet finishes.

Tim wants to protest that he is in fact very good at keeping secrets. He is keeping a big one from them right now even, but words are caught in his throat.

“C’mon bud, you’re old enough to be emancipated. You can take care of yourself just fine now. We’ll admit you might have been too immature at ten, but you’re practically an adult now!” Jack wheedles.

Tim just says, “I’ll think about it.” He knows he’s not really being given an option, but he makes to escape back into the school now that they’ve said what they needed to.

“Our lawyers will call you!” Jack calls after him.

Tim no longer feels hungry and he curls up in the library, fighting back tears. His time being a part of a loving family is over. He knew it would never last.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 It sucks having empathy for people who don’t

Tim has been so conflicted on his altercation with his parents. He had always planned on saving their lives even if he didn’t live with them. No matter how much they hurt him, they’re still his parents and he had grieved for them and what could have been (even if they didn’t deserve it). He can’t just stand by and let them die. Feeling empathy and love can be such a burden sometimes.

He arranges to have Batman and Robin investigate and arrest Obeah Man before he can kidnap Jack and Janet.

With the prevention of his parents and Robin’s deaths, Tim wonders if he should just listen to them. There’s no need for him at Wayne Manor anymore outside of Parakeet. Tim assumes that it’ll go back to how it was like in his past life. He’ll stay in Drake Manor and only go over to Wayne Manor for patrols.

Like Janet had said. He’s just burdening the Waynes, and he doesn’t need their pity. He’s fine just being their next door neighbor. The past few years were more than Tim could have ever hoped for. Jason and Damian regard him like a brother, he gets to patrol with the Bats once again, and he got to live in a house that wasn’t dark or empty.

Janet and Jack's words start to bring out insecurities that Tim thought were long dormant. Maybe Bruce had only adopted him in the previous timeline because he felt responsible for Tim as Robin after his parents died. Bruce is also too responsible to have let ten-year-old Tim keep living alone. Jason's refusal to be separated from him could have forced Bruce to foster him. Like his sperm donor mentioned, he's now old enough to be emancipated, so Bruce should no longer feel this obligation.

Tim can still perform his duties as Parakeet and look after the Waynes from afar. He'll make sure nothing happens to them. He's starting to think he's just better off going along with his parents' plans.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 It's one thing for a normal person to be caught off guard, but if you can see the future like me, it's a one in a million chance to be caught off guard. That chance just happened.

With the amount of predications Tim makes daily on his Twitter account, it's hard to believe that he couldn't have predicted this.

Staring wide-eyed at his foster father and siblings as they lounge in a sitting room and look at him expectantly, he can only gasp out a "W-what?"

He glances down at the papers on the coffee table in front of him and can't seem to connect to the lightbulb in his brain.

"Baby bird, we want you to be a part of the family in every way that counts. I kept doubting my place as B's son when I was just his ward, and this is one of the ways he was able to cement that he loves me and wants to be my dad," Dick explains, "I thought you would need the reassurance too."

"But..my parents are still alive. I'm not an orphan," Tim states confusedly.

Jason scoffs. “Like those assholes deserve to be called parents. You were the one that told me it wasn’t my biological parents that I reflect, but the people who *chose* to be my parents. You won’t need to deal with them ever again,” he says pointedly.

“Tim..” Bruce approaches tentatively, “I know that your parents have started contacting you again.”

Tim gasps, still in a state of shock, “What, how??”

“Your twitter posts got depressing, so I was concerned and went to B. We saw that their lawyers were calling you. They couldn’t even be bothered to call you themselves!” Jason explains, though his face grows more heated as he speaks.

Bruce continues the conversation, “Further, less legal, approaches showed that they’re trying to sue for custody back. I wanted to nip that in the bud. You’re my son, and I don’t think they’ll be able to care for you like I am. I..love you, Tim. Please let me adopt you?”

Tim exhales gustily, “Wouldn’t it just be easier for them to just get custody? They won’t be home very often so I could still stay with you guys most of the time and it won’t affect patrol. I don’t want to cause you trouble with a legal battle,” he questions, nervously.

“Tt. You’re worth it!” Damian speaks up finally. Tim doesn’t think he’s seen the baby bat this quiet or still. “I want you to be my brother legally too so no one can ever take you away!” he continues obstinately.

The nine-year-old is still as attached to Tim as ever. Tim’s kind of getting concerned it’s edging towards possessiveness, but honestly it’s nice to be coveted. Damian seems as spoiled as he was in his previous life, but it’s softened by his genuine care and love. He wants the best for both himself and everyone he loves.

“I have already worked out a custody agreement with your parents, Tim. As I am your guardian, they had no right to go to school and accost you like that. I can get a restraining order against them if that is what you want,” Bruce reveals.

Tim turns to face him surprised. “They’re okay with you adopting me?” he asks.

“Not necessarily okay with it, but more like they didn’t have a choice unless they wanted to be arrested for the artifacts they have stolen on their trips,” Bruce corrects.

“Yeah! They have a lot of shit they aren’t supposed to have. B threatened to expose them so they folded. Fuckers care more about their reputation than you, which is good for us because it’s their loss!” Jason rants.

“B just sent Selina a list of the artifacts so I don’t think they’ll be in custody of them for much longer,” Dick giggles, “you better sign the papers before they realize they’ve been had.”

Tim numbly picks up a pen, still processing his entire viewpoint being decimated.

A soft hand covers his own for a second, and he looks up into Bruce’s soft eyes. “We all love you Tim, but don’t feel forced to do this. What is it you really want? All we want is for you to be happy,” he expresses.

“I-” Tim licks his dry lips, “I want to be adopted,” he replies shakily, and a cheer erupts from his family.

Once Tim signs all the papers, Dick tackles them all into a group hug. Tim can’t help the bright smile that crosses his face. The doom he had been feeling for the past few days fades into oblivion, never to be seen again. He’s legally and permanently Bruce’s kid. Nothing can take him away from the Waynes anymore. In fact he is officially a Wayne now. Timothy Jackson Drake-Wayne.

God he never thought he would have this again when he changed the timeline. In fact, it’s even better now because he knows for sure it’s because he belongs and is wanted and not out of a sense of obligation.

“I’m finally cashing in that favor you owe me, baby bird! Daily hugs for the rest of your life! It doesn’t matter who it is, but I *will* be checking,” Dick announces.

Jason bursts out laughing while Tim groans. Jason had already had his favor called in when Bludhaven stopped selling Dick’s favorite cereal. Dick asked him to drive from Gotham to Bludhaven to drop off bags of that cereal until they started selling it again. Tim had thankfully not been allowed to drive at that time so he thought he had escaped. Unfortunately, that doesn’t seem to be the case.

“Why are your favors so much longer than what we asked of you? Our favor lasted just for the weekend!” Tim complains.

“That’s what you get for not setting limits, Timmy! Your favor took years off my life,” Dick responds sweetly.

“What favor are you speaking of?” Damian chimes in curiously.

Bruce just sighs.

Tim sinks into the group hug even more. He thinks back to the promise he had given Jason three years ago. Jason had been to see Dinah a few times, but Tim hadn’t found the courage to go. Maybe he should go talk to her and see what she says about his abandonment and self esteem issues. She can’t make them worse right?

Resolving to talk to Bruce about it later, Tim breaks away from the group and wipes his teary eyes. “I love you all too,” he chokes out. They all smile at him, and Dick is the only one not trying to hide that he’s crying too. Alfred enters with some comfort snacks, and smiles warmly at Tim when he sees the signed papers.

Without the fear of having to leave hanging over him, Tim finally feels completely at home.

Chapter End Notes

As a counseling psychology student, I'm really hyping up the importance of therapy haha

There's only one last chapter to conclude the whole thing! This has been a wild ride and I enjoyed every minute (hour) of it.

Any feedback is appreciated!

Explaining the Birds and Bats

Chapter Summary

Darkseid arrives again and Tim has to figure out how to defeat him. Thankfully he now has a meta-power on his side. How will the battle turn out?

Chapter Notes

This is the final chapter of the story! I hope it is a satisfying ending!

Thank you all for sticking around to the end of the story!

Happy birthday Pinkie and happy reading to you all!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Sometimes I think Lex Luthor's sanity disappeared with his hair.

@the_smartest_man_who_ever_lived It's the price one has to pay for their genius

@life_is_a_soup_and_im_a_fork 😂😂😂 It's a price we all have to pay cuz *we* have to see that egghead. Do mirrors crack when you look at them? Then again, your head is shiny enough to *be* a mirror.

@the_smartest_man_who_ever_lived This is slander! My lawyers will hear about this!

Tim's had a lot of fun saving lives over the years. It's a lot easier when he has the ability to control Z.

The most notable, currently, is the time he saved Superman's life. Imagine that. Regular old (okay not *that* regular) Tim being able to save the Man of Steel.

A large reason why Lex Luthor's plan succeeded so well was because he made Batman doubt Superman, and he used Superman's mom as a bargaining chip. His machinations led to Doomsday being able to kill Superman.

Tim had multiple pathways he could have taken to stop this from happening, and he also had the resources to try all of them.

First, he tried helping defeat Doomsday before he could kill Superman. He was able to do so, with knowledge about a large store of Kryptonite Lex Luthor had. However, though he was able to rid Luthor of his Kryptonite supply, Tim was unable to get him to truly face any consequences. He just went on to his next evil supervillain plot the next day. Additionally, this led to irreparable damage to Batman and Superman's trust in one another. For people he knew to become best friends, this was not something Tim could live with.

On the second try, he prevented Martha Kent's kidnapping by kidnapping her first and taking her to Wayne Manor. She and Alfred got along splendidly. Sorry Lex, only Tim's allowed to kidnap people. He also put a lot more focus on preserving Batman and Superman's friendship, helping them maintain their trust in one another. He made them do trust falls and everything. This way, they were able to work together to defeat Doomsday, but Luthor got away with the part he played.

Finally, Tim eventually realized to completely achieve victory, he needed to go straight to the source. Tim focused all his efforts into completely ruining Lex Luthor. He got a fake internship at LexCorp under the name Alvin Draper and investigated *every. little*. infraction Lex had made, including his tax evasion and unpaid parking tickets.

He anonymously sent what he found to one Clark Kent at the Daily Planet, and he asked Bruce Wayne to make sure that Lex isn't able to pay off any courts. All corrupt corporate lawyers were suddenly disbarred when their corruption was exposed, so Lex was only stuck with ethical lawyers and judges. After a month-long trial (the shitload of felonies he committed took weeks to go through and the evidence was overwhelming) Lex Luthor was convicted and lost all credibility (and probably money with the amount of fines he was given).

As LexCorp's stocks tanked, an anonymous buyer ended up taking ownership of the corporation to root out its corruption and compete with Wayne Enterprises for Most Ethical Company (seemed like a good way to piss Lex off).

If Tim can be CEO of WE at seventeen, he can probably run LexCorp a lot better than the previous owner. For example, all Kryptonite was turned over to the Justice League, and a deal was made with them if any more shows up to make sure it doesn't get into the wrong hands.

As the new owner, Tim gets access to the various projects they are working on. One project of particular interest, CADMUS, revealed the illegal genetic experimentation with cloning technology. As much as Tim is glad CADMUS brought Kon into this world, he made sure to completely destroy all of what Luthor worked towards as the once powerful man sits in a cell.

One clone of Superman is enough.

This time around, Tim also made sure to help develop close trust and friendship between Superman and Batman, so it seems Superman picked up Batman's penchant for taking in blue-eyed, black-haired boys. Conner Kent's newfound adoptive parents, Clark Kent and Lois Lane, make sure the boy gets all the support he needs.

Without the support of Lex Luthor, with Tim's preparation, and with the Justice League's new access to tons of Kryptonite, Doomsday is no match for the Bats. He is actually defeated quite easily.

All in all, this goes to show how Tim has been able to find the best case scenario in different possible tragedies, and save lives while doing it. Tim wouldn't call himself the Chosen One or anything like that, but he feels like his power is a bit OP. Villains have no way of winning unless they also possess time travel powers themselves, and usually he lets Flash handle them.

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 The history book on the shelf is always repeating itself, but we all have the ability to change it.

Here we are again. Tim sighs, looking over the chaotic battlefield. To think this was the incident that has led him to this moment (again).

He eyes the Omega Ray that gave him his power. Something tells him that it isn't the original purpose of the ray. Why would Darkseid want to make his enemies more powerful?

He wants to see what would happen if he lets the ray hit Bruce. Will Bruce be sent back in time and develop the meta-power as well?

Tim watches as the ray bursts towards a distracted Batman, none of the other League members able to step in and help.

Tim doesn't know what to expect. Will Bruce dodge out of the way because he had gone back in time and knows that it's coming? Tim almost wishes that is what happened because when the light fades, it reveals the still form of Batman.

He stumbles toward the body, hoping that he's just unconscious or something, but an instinct deep in his gut tells him that it's not the case. Tim falls to his knees by Batman's collapsed body, feeling for a pulse. When he can't feel anything and there are no signs of breathing, Tim screams because the only other option is to throw up.

He stumbles when he lands, still feeling queasy. No matter his power, seeing his dad's dead body is sickening. Tim needs to lock in.

He sucks in a deep calming breath and focuses on what's around him. He had screamed too loud and was transported right before the beginning of the battle.

He doesn’t want to take any chances. He needs to make sure that B is completely out of the line of fire. He also doesn’t want to try different variations like he normally would do. No way in hell would he be able to take seeing B die again.

The only way to be completely sure is either if he can convince B not to join the battle (literally impossible) or to make sure to transport B out of the way. Tim still hasn’t used his power while touching another living being, but he doesn’t know how else to prevent the beam from hitting anyone without going through multiple different pathways. If he keeps B out of the way, someone else could be hit instead.

Parakeet sticks to Batman like glue in the ensuing battle. When Tim had turned fifteen, Jason had asked to pass the Robin mantle over to him because he wanted to go out as a new vigilante called Phoenix. Tim had refused, loving how it felt to be Parakeet. He had told them to save the mantle for Damian if he wants it when he’s older. One thing that changed after that proposition, however, was that Batman had let Parakeet go out in the field for emergencies.

Tim had missed being able to patrol from time to time. Sure, he still preferred his role inside the Batcave, but being able to stretch out his atrophied fighting skills was amazing. The Bats, bar Jason, were very surprised at how easily Tim picked up his training, but he was able to use martial arts classes as an excuse. Damian, always admiring Tim, asked him to train him as well so Tim started teaching him a few safe ways to defend himself. They all agreed not to actually train Damian as a vigilante until he is much older and brings it up himself.

As Darkseid’s attack constitutes as an emergency, it’s all hands on deck right now. Although Tim had never been Robin in this timeline, Parakeet and Batman still fight fluidly together. They move in sync in a way that reminds Tim so much of his time as Robin. The nostalgia should probably not be kicking in in the middle of an invasion, but Tim can’t help it. Fighting alongside his family is exhilarating.

When Tim notices the ray powering up, he grabs Batman in a bear hug and cries out.

Time-traveling with a person is not that much different than it usually is. Sure Tim collapses from the unexpected weight of Batman in his arms, but it’s almost like holding a giant teddy bear. One that flails a whole lot.

Batman grunts in surprise and shock as he finds himself experiencing deja vu from within his son's arms and at a different angle.

“What happened?” he growls.

Tim gulps. “Um.. I think we got hit by that big ass ray gun?” he says hesitantly, trying one last ditch effort to cover up his power.

“No. This happened before it hit.” Batman responds stubbornly.

Tim sighs. “I’ll tell you later, B. Right now we need to kick some alien ass.” he says, trying to distract his attention for now.

Batman gives him a long searching look before grunting in agreement and moving into the fray, being extra cautious to avoid the Omega ray now.

The rest of the battle is a blur, and the Justice League (and allies) come out panting with exhaustion, but victorious. Tim is now officially in new territory having passed the moment he got sent back in time.

Tim is so not ready for the discussion that he knows is going to happen, but he subjects himself to his fate and follows the rest of the Bats back to the Batcave.

After completing their reports, Bruce (now with the cowl off) veers on Tim.

“Now,” he announces, “we are going to talk about something that occurred on the battlefield that Tim promised to explain.”

Tim shrinks in on himself, but he knows that tone. It’s one that brooks no argument. After 7 years of hiding his power from Bruce and Dick, Tim has no idea why he still does so. Maybe he’s worried Bruce will go all Frankenstein and start treating him like a science experiment.

Okay that's bullshit. Tim can always scream and go back in time if he ends up like that, but he knows Bruce would never do something like that even if he's curious.

What he finds so hard to admit to himself is that he's worried they won't believe him. Jason and Damian were so young when they found out. Damian, the curious child, had gone through his notebook he used for patrols a couple years ago, so Jason and Tim had to explain and swear him to secrecy. Ever eager for approval, Damian has been very tight-lipped, and thus has been let in on their shenanigans.

Because Jason and Damian were so young, they were more open to the possibility (and Jason was willing to believe anything for shelter, food, and safety). Tim is scared Dick, Bruce, and Alfred would think he's crazy or reject him. Though he knows it's unlikely they will hate him for being meta because they all have meta friends, Tim also knows all about the no metas in Gotham rule and is worried they'll try and kick him out.

Nevertheless, he is here now, and he has to have faith that everything will work out. At least he has Jason for moral support.

"Can we have a family meeting with everyone? I don't want to explain it more than once," Tim asks.

Dick and Bruce exchange glances and nod while Jason looks questioningly at him, concerned.

After they have all changed into civilian clothes and have gathered with Alfred and Damian in a sitting room (the same one where Tim gave his presentation for adoption in), Tim nervously reveals his secret.

"Um..you know the giant ray that Darkseid had in the battle? Originally I was hit by the ray and sent back in time. I ended up getting a meta time travel power that I have been using to help fix the timeline. Like for example, Jason died in my original timeline, and I ended up taking the Robin mantle, because Batman in mourning was getting too violent.." Tim starts explaining. Some of this information is new to Jason and Damian as well, so they're all listening raptly.

“In this timeline, I prevented it, so I was never Robin, but I don’t mind because I enjoy being Parakeet more! This is also why I knew about Damian. In my timeline, Talia drops him off when he’s ten and he’s brainwashed by the League of Assassins,” Tim continued.

“What’s the League of Assassins? And who’s Talia?” Damian interjects.

“Don’t worry about it Damian. They’re an evil cult, but I won’t let them get you,” Tim reassures.

“You’ve been helping us all behind the scenes?” Bruce speaks up, sounding stunned.

“Yup, he's been babysitting all of our asses on patrol. Haven’t you wondered why it got so much easier?” Jason retorts.

“YOU KNEW??” Dick exclaims, sounding betrayed.

“I knew too,” Damian announces, not wanting to be left out.

“WHAT?! Tim, why am I the only one of the siblings that didn’t know?” Dick questions, turning to Tim teary-eyed and pouting.

Tim decides to be completely honest with his family from now on. He trusts them completely. “I was worried you, B, and Alfred wouldn’t believe me because you’re a lot older than Jason and Damian were when they found out. Children are easier to convince and are more open to things,” Tim explains.

“Of course, we would have listened to you and tried to understand, Master Tim,” Alfred replies.

Bruce, the one who is usually the most paranoid, also replies, “Although I will need additional proof, the fact that I trust you and witnessed it first-hand is enough for me to

believe you, sweetheart."

Tim tears up, grateful for the support. "Wait, B witnessed it firsthand? What do you mean?" Jason asks curiously.

"I used my power to bring B back in time with me because that Omega ray would have killed him," Tim says mournfully.

"Ah, so you *can* bring people back. I volunteer as tribute to try it out next time," Jason says excitedly.

"No, I want to!" Damian argues.

"Wait, you didn't know you could before you did it?" Dick asks.

TIm shifts uncomfortably, "I hadn't tried before because I was nervous there would be ill effects, but I was desperate this time because, you know, B would have died," he explains.

Dick nods in understanding and then continues, "By the way, I also believe you! Think of all the potential this could have for chaos!"

Bruce sighs, looking like he already dreads what is to come. "Dick please do not use your brother for mischief-making," he warns.

"But what if Tim wants to?" Dick asks, giving him puppy-dog eyes.

This makes Bruce turn back to Tim. "We need to establish some ground rules about you using your power," he pleads, looking scared that Tim would use them to take over the world (which he totally could if he wanted to), "I'm worried about how safe it is if you use it. Are there any drawbacks?"

Tim relaxes when he realizes that the rules are out of concern and safety, not control. “Not that I know of other than a sore throat sometimes because screaming is what activates it,” Tim replies.

Dick continues the interrogation, “Have you used it to help me too?” he asks eagerly.

“He’s the one that got you two dumbasses to talk when you were fighting. He’s the reason you’re adopted Dickhead,” Jason butts in.

Dick and Bruce freeze, while Alfred just looks amused. “YOU’RE THE FORTUNE TELLER??” Dick yells.

Tim smirks, “Wasn’t it obvious. Jeez, I thought you two were detectives. Why else would they be so involved in Bruce Wayne and Batman’s lives? I literally *just* said I could go back in time.”

“Wait, wait, wait,” Dick flails his arms, still looking flabbergasted. Bruce is in a similar state. “I need you to show me this in action. Alfred and I are the only ones here who haven’t seen you do it!” Dick insists.

“Ok.. how about you show me a card and I’ll go back in time and guess it,” Tim suggests.

Tim leaves the room and the four of them pick out a card from a deck. He goes back in when they’re ready and they show him that it’s a joker (very funny guys 🙄). He then makes a very little yelp and gets sent back to when he’s outside waiting for them to pick a card.

When Dick yells that they’re ready, Tim bursts through the door announcing, “It’s a joker!”

Dick and Bruce look startled while Jason and Damian burst into giggles. Alfred is still smiling in amusement, though he looks a little impressed as well.

With everyone in his family convinced about his power, Dick mischievously announces that they are now going to have bonding nights after Saturday dinners where they are going to use Tim's power to have a little fun. Now that they are all in on it, the Waynes are going to have a blast messing with everyone. Dick laments on how many prank opportunities he missed out on while Bruce and Alfred shake their heads, but seem just as excited to see what havoc they can wreak.

Tim giggles as they pile on him in a group hug. He can't wait for all the shenanigans they are all going to get up to now that he has brought this family together and they know about his power. He is going to do everything in his power to keep them this way: happy (and alive).

…

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 @greengod Hey Green Lantern, you better stay away from Gotham, or the Bats are going to turn you into a vampire.

@greengod what do you mean the bats arent vampires i talk to spooky all the time

@greengod right?

@Not_Batman I request that you take this post down. I'd like this to remain private.

@greengod wait spooky its true???

@life_is_a_soup_and_im_a_fork Dude can you use any punctuation marks other than the question mark?

@electric_bluebird Why do you think we only come out at night?

@WonderWoman We'll support you no matter what Batman. You are our comrade.

@Big_Blue_Official Yeah! I agree with Wonder Woman. I mean I'm an alien and she's an Amazonian. We can't really judge.

@greengod wearing a turtleneck every time i go to gotham

@phoenix_the_badass_bitch Like that's gonna stop us MUAHAHAHAHA

@greengod you sure youre not a villain?

@phoenix_the_badass_bitch I will be if you keep using that abysmal grammar and assault my eyes with it. 🔫

@greedgod what does abyzmel mean?

@phoenix_the_badass_bitch That's it.

@greengod OH MY GOD PHOENIX IS A LITERAL ZOMBIE HELP

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 You'll be okay. Not like you have any brains for him to eat.

…

@the_detectives_baby_mama Motherhood is such a fulfilling experience, but it's so hard when I'm being kept from my child. I spent three years raising my son on my own, and then his father comes and just snatches up custody of him. Now I can't see him anymore, but his father's thieving girlfriend can.

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 Honey, you forgot that the only reason you were a single mom at first was because you didn't tell the father he had a son. You were found to be incapable of taking care of your son and banned from seeing him because you were raising him to be an assassin. Plus you were a creep and literally froze his father's sperm to preserve it and get pregnant (literally the weirdest baby trap).

@random_gothamite You know I'm used to all kinds of crazy shit, but that's wild.

@immortaldemonhead Daughter didn't I tell you that the heir's training will be better under the leadership of the Detectives? Anyone that can thwart our every attempt at stealing him back will be able to teach him many valuable things.

@life_is_a_soup_and_im_a_fork Please like you know anything about motherhood 🙄

@dick_the_flying_grayson Maybe you should reflect on why no one likes you.

@purple_waffles Damn and you're supposed to be the nice one.

@gotmilk? Who are you?

@the_real_Bruce_Wayne Damian, why are you on social media? You're too young, you're only ten.

@gotmilk? All my classmates have it!! 😤😡🤬

@life_is_a_soup_and_im_a_fork LMAO did you just cuss at Dad? Also who are you asking for milk? 😉 Got any grapes? 🍇

@gotmilk? Tt **.** I did not cuss! I do not even know what that means. I am asking for milk from cows, who else? And no, I don't have grapes you imbecile! To think I, who is ten years younger than you, can type more coherently.

@the_detectives_baby_mama Hello, habibi. If these brats are bothering you, you're welcome to come back and live with me. You'll have all the riches and power you could ask for.

@gotmilk? Tt. Who are you, woman? I was advised to not speak to or go with strangers. I have plenty of riches and power as a Wayne.

@dick_the_flying_grayson JASON! Do NOT corrupt your baby brother. He's TEN. @gotmilk? Damian, delete Twitter.

@gotmilk? Tt. Fine, mother 🙄

@the_detectives_baby_mama Who dares think they can replace me as Damian's mother 🔪

@gotmilk? Farewell all of you, it was nice seeing those so called memes even though I didn't understand many of them. Can someone still explain what the significance of replying 'yo mama' is when I ask

@tim_is_moneyC8H10N4O2 🎶 then he waddled away..waddle, waddle 🎶

Chapter End Notes

And that's the conclusion of this story! I imagine they all live HEA, causing all sorts of chaos in this world haha.

This was Bruce's chapter, as Tim saves his life (really from the time stream but they don't know that) and fully confides in him.

As always, any comment, kudos, or reader is loved and appreciated!

Thank you all for reading until the end!! 😘

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!